

11 Quine and Strawson — Offline Revision Guide

Philosophy Optional · Paper I · Western Philosophy · Topic 11

Syllabus boundary: Quine and Strawson: Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic Particulars and Persons.

Source lineage: The authoritative completed formal session/workbook, canonical owner file and verified 2018–2026 PYQ ledgers were read. The canonical owner file is substantially retained where it was already final; source cells were reconciled, adapted and mapped, repeated teaching apparatus was consolidated, the complete 42-panel formal atlas was restored, and new 2026/PYQ/validator controls were added. Mechanical overlap and witness checks do not prove semantic completeness.

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Page numbers are generated from the final layout. PDF bookmarks include finer subheadings.

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Release boundary and ownership

Printed burden	Primary owner	Required result
Critique of empiricism	Quine	two dogmas, failed analyticity explications, reductionism, holism, revisability and qualified empiricism
Basic particulars	Strawson	descriptive metaphysics, public spatio-temporal identification and material bodies
Persons	Strawson	primitive person, M/P predicates, self-/other-ascription and anti-dualist consequence

Quinean naturalism, holism and regimentation must not be merged with Strawsonian descriptive metaphysics. Russell's positive theory of descriptions remains Topic 06-owned; Logical Positivism's positive verification programme remains Topic 07-owned. Topic 11 owns the criticisms and rival analyses only where the principal burden is Quine or Strawson.

Coverage roadmap

QUINE

Two Dogmas -> failed analyticity circle -> reductionism rejected

-> corporate testing -> web of belief -> revisability with minimum

mutilation

-> naturalized epistemology / ontological commitment

-> radical translation -> gavagai -> inscrutability / indeterminacy /

relativity

STRAWSON

descriptive metaphysics -> identification and re-identification

-> one public spatio-temporal framework -> material bodies

-> persons as primitive -> M + P predicates -> self/other ascription

-> On Referring -> use, context and presupposition against Russell

QUINE AND STRAWSON — Syllabus Item 11 (Paper I · Section A)

Syllabus (verbatim): Quine and Strawson : Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic Particulars and Persons. **Evidence key:** ✅ canonical doctrine · ⚠️ analytical synthesis (mine, for exam use) · ❓ contested/uncertain **Placement:** Two mid-20th-century analytic philosophers with distinct printed burdens. This owner carries 10 primary-owned parts in 2018–2026, with no primary-owned part in 2022. Quine supplies the printed critique of empiricism; Strawson supplies the printed theories of basic particulars and persons, including spatio-temporal identification.

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP ⚠️

QUINE (1908–2000)	STRAWSON (1919–2006)
"Two Dogmas of Empiricism" (1951)	Individuals (1959) "On Referring" (1950)
DOGMA 1: analytic/synthetic distinction → untenable (circle of synonymy)	DESCRIPTIVE METAPHYSICS vs revisionary metaphysics
DOGMA 2: reductionism/verificationism → untenable	BASIC PARTICULARS = material bodies (re-identifiable in one spatio-temporal framework)
POSITIVE: CONFIRMATION HOLISM "web of belief" – no statement immune to revision	PERSONS = primitive concept M-predicates + P-predicates → undercuts dualism AND no-ownership theory
Bound-variable commitment criterion a bound variable"	
Indeterminacy of translation Ontological relativity	"On Referring" – presupposition vs Russell's assertion of existence

🔑 **Mnemonic — "Quine kills TWO dogmas; Strawson saves TWO Ps":** Quine → analytic/synthetic

+ reductionism destroyed. Strawson → **Particulars** (material bodies) + **Persons** (primitive concept).

0A. PRINTED OWNERSHIP AND ENRICHMENT FIREWALL

The official clause is most safely parsed by the standard division used in the verified PYQs:

Printed limb	Primary owner	Marks-essential doctrine
Critique of Empiricism	Quine	two dogmas, failed explications of analyticity, reductionism, confirmation holism, revisability and empiricism without the dogmas
Theory of Basic Particulars	Strawson	descriptive metaphysics, identification/re-identification, public spatio-temporal framework and material bodies
Theory of Persons	Strawson	person as primitive, physical and psychological predicates, self-/other-ascription, dualism and no-ownership foil

- Quine's ontological commitment, naturalized epistemology, radical translation, inscrutability of reference and ontological relativity are **bounded system-enrichment**, not independently printed or PYQ-owned in 2018–2025.
- Strawson's "On Referring," Kant interpretation, transcendental arguments, induction, reactive attitudes and free-will work are **bounded enrichment or cross-owner material**. They must not displace basic particulars and persons.
- Strawson can illuminate weaknesses in sense-datum empiricism, but the printed "Critique of Empiricism" burden should not be reassigned from Quine or turned into a claim that Quine and Strawson form one anti-empiricist front.
- Russell, Logical Positivism, Later Wittgenstein and Kant retain their positive systems; only demand-specific contrasts belong here.

1. QUINE — CRITIQUE OF EMPIRICISM: "TWO DOGMAS OF EMPIRICISM" ✓

1.1 Overview ✓

Quine attacks **two unquestioned dogmas** of logical empiricism (the Vienna Circle / Ayer / Carnap tradition):

Dogma	Content	Why Quine calls it a dogma
1. The analytic/synthetic distinction	There is a principled, non-arbitrary line between statements true-by-meaning (analytic) and statements true-by-fact (synthetic)	The distinction cannot be non-circularly defined

Dogma	Content	Why Quine calls it a dogma
2. Reductionism (verificationism)	Each meaningful statement is individually reducible to (confirmable/disconfirmable by) a range of sense-experience	Statements face experience <i>as a corporate body</i> , not individually

1.2 Dogma 1 — The Analytic/Synthetic Distinction is Untenable (PYQ 2025, 2024, 2021, 2019)

The Circle of Synonymy:

Quine examines every candidate explanation of "analytic" and shows each presupposes another term that itself presupposes analyticity:

"Analytic" = true by virtue of meaning

→ What is "meaning"? → SYNONYMY ("bachelor" means "unmarried man")

→ What is synonymy? → DEFINITION (one term defined by another)

→ But definitions merely record pre-existing synonymies → CIRCULAR

→ Or: INTERCHANGEABILITY *salva veritate* (substituting one for the other preserves truth-value in all contexts)

→ Works only if we already have the notion of "necessity" or

"analyticity" to distinguish extensional from intensional contexts →

CIRCULAR

→ Or: SEMANTICAL RULES (Carnap – analyticity relative to an artificial language L)

→ Explicit lists can classify sentences in a stipulated L, but the general

explanatory notion "semantical rule" remains no clearer than analyticity

Conclusion: Quine argues that the available explications fail to provide the clear, non-question-begging boundary that logical empiricism required. He does not infer merely from the absence of one dictionary definition that every use of "analytic" is unintelligible. 

 **Exam Note:** Quine does NOT say "All bachelors are unmarried" is false. He argues that the available accounts do not secure the sharp, foundational analytic/synthetic boundary. Holistic revisability then replaces categorical immunity with degrees of practical entrenchment; entrenchment itself is not a synonym for analyticity.

 **Centrality caution:** practical entrenchment in the web explains why logic and mathematics are normally protected from revision; it is not itself a replacement definition of "analytic."

1.3 Dogma 2 — Reductionism

The second dogma is the assumption that each individual statement has its own private stock of confirming or disconfirming experiences — that it can be "verified" (or refuted) in isolation.

Quine rejects this: **no statement has its meaning (or its confirmation conditions) in isolation from the rest of the system.** This is "reductionism" because it attempts to *reduce* the meaning of each sentence to a set of observation sentences. ✓

1.4 Positive Doctrine: Confirmation Holism — The Web of Belief ✓ (PYQ 2025 Q4(b))

✓ *"Our statements about the external world face the tribunal of sense experience not individually but only as a corporate body."*

The metaphor of the web (or field of force):

- Our total system of beliefs is like a **web** or **field of force** whose boundary conditions are experience.
- Sensory experience touches only the **edges** (peripheral observational sentences).
- The **interior** contains more "theoretical" statements (physics, mathematics, logic) — farther from the edge.
- When experience conflicts with a prediction at the edge, we must **revise** somewhere in the web — but we have **choice** about where:
- We can revise a nearby peripheral belief (easiest).
- We can in principle revise a deep interior belief. The early essay extends revisability even to logic, but later Quine stresses minimum mutilation and warns that a sufficiently radical "change of logic" can amount to changing the subject.
- We can "plead hallucination" — revise the observation statement itself.

✓ *"Any statement can be held true come what may, if we make drastic enough adjustments elsewhere in the system."* (The 2025 Q4(b) quotation.)

✓ *"Conversely, by the same token, no statement is immune to revision."* The early passage includes logic in principle; it does not imply that every revision is equally rational or that logic is casually abandoned. ✓

Consequences:

Consequence	Explanation
No sharp analytic/synthetic line	Central logic/mathematics are highly entrenched and normally protected, but centrality must not be equated with a new definition of analyticity
No sharp a priori/a posteriori line	All beliefs are revisable in the light of experience (even if remote from the periphery)
Pragmatism about theory-choice	When revision is needed, we choose on grounds of simplicity, conservatism, fecundity — pragmatic virtues, not algorithmic rules

Consequence	Explanation
Pressure on positivist meaning-criteria	Sentence-by-sentence reductionist verification is undermined; holistic verificationism is a further question

1.5 Bounded Quinean System-Enrichment — Not Independently Printed/PYQ-Owned



Ontological commitment — “To be is to be the value of a bound variable”:

1. First **regiment** an accepted theory into perspicuous quantificational form.
2. The theory is ontologically committed to whatever entities must lie in the ranges of its bound variables for the theory to be true.
3. This is a **criterion of commitment**, not a mechanical rule for choosing which total theory or ontology to accept. Theory-choice still invokes empirical adequacy, simplicity, conservatism and explanatory power.
4. Commitment is not surface word-counting: names can be paraphrased away, while apparently name-free quantification can carry commitment.
5. Quine's “taste for desert landscapes” expresses parsimony, not nominalism at any cost. He accepts abstract entities where the best regimented science indispensably quantifies over them; the broader indispensability argument is commonly associated with Quine and Putnam and should not be attributed to one slogan alone. ⚠️

Indeterminacy of translation:

There is no *fact of the matter* about which translation of a foreign sentence into English is “correct.” Multiple incompatible translation manuals can fit all possible behavioural evidence equally well. This reinforces the attack on determinate “meanings” and “synonymy.” ⚠️ — **fully reconstructed at §1.7 below.**

Naturalized epistemology:

Philosophy is not an external *a priori* foundation of science; inquiry proceeds from within the revisable scientific web. Quine proposes a scientific study of how sensory input produces theoretical output, famously relocating epistemology within psychology. ⚠️

- **Normative objection:** a causal story about belief acquisition appears to replace the question “What ought one believe?” with “How is belief produced?”
- **Quinean reply:** prediction, truth-seeking and method-selection can themselves be studied and improved from within science; later formulations allow a naturalized normative “engineering” of inquiry.
- **Residual:** continuity with science blocks first philosophy but does not by itself derive epistemic norms from causal facts.

1.6 THE DUHEM–QUINE THESIS ✅ — the engine of holism, and the two halves of it

Statement. A scientific hypothesis is never confronted by experience **alone**. It generates testable predictions only in conjunction with auxiliary hypotheses, background theory, instrument theory and initial conditions. Therefore a failed prediction condemns only the **conjunction**, and logic alone never tells us which conjunct to give up.

The two contributions — do not merge them ⚠️ (this is the most examinable precision on the sub-topic): | | **DUHEM** — *La Théorie physique: son objet, sa structure* (1906) | **QUINE** — "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" (1951) | |---|---|---| | **Scope** | **Physics only**. Duhem explicitly restricts the thesis to theoretical physics, and holds that physiology and certain other sciences *can* test hypotheses more nearly in isolation | **All of knowledge**. "The unit of empirical significance is **the whole of science**" | | **Logic and mathematics** | **Exempt** — Duhem does not put them at risk | **Included** — "no statement is immune to revision," not even a law of logic | | **Chief corollary** | There is no automatic *experimentum crucis* against an isolated hypothesis, since auxiliaries are also in play | confirmation holism and underdetermination pressure; the stronger claim of rival total theories equivalent under all possible evidence requires further argument | | **Motive** | philosophy of physics; the practice of physicists | the demolition of the second dogma, reductionism |

The argument, numbered: 1. Let H be the hypothesis under test, A the auxiliary assumptions, and O the observational prediction. The testable claim is $(H \ \& \ A) \rightarrow O$. 2. Observation reports $\neg O$. 3. By *modus tollens*, all that follows is $\neg(H \ \& \ A)$ — i.e. H is false **or** some element of A is false. 4. Logic does not say which conjunct to reject. Evidence, background knowledge and methodological virtues can still make some revisions much more reasonable than others. 5. $\therefore$ Refutation is never conclusive against a single statement — and, symmetrically, ✅ **"any statement can be held true come what may, if we make drastic enough adjustments elsewhere in the system."** 6. $\therefore$ A reductionist criterion assigning each statement its own confirming experiences has no application. This directly attacks the second dogma; it pressures, but does not by itself refute, every possible holistic verificationism.

Canonical historical example ✅ — **Uranus and Neptune**. Anomalies in Uranus's orbit conflicted with Newtonian predictions. Astronomers did **not** abandon Newton's laws; they revised the auxiliary assumption about the number of planets, and **Neptune** was found (Le Verrier and Adams, 1846). The identical strategy applied to Mercury's perihelion produced the hypothesised planet "**Vulcan**" — which does not exist, and there the correct revision turned out to be the deep one: general relativity (1915). ⚠️ **The pair together is the perfect illustration:** the same logical situation, opposite correct responses, and no rule saying in advance which to choose. Deploy both, not just Neptune.

Presuppositions ⚠️ : (P1) hypotheses generate predictions with auxiliaries; (P2) no fixed decomposition uniquely assigns every recalcitrant experience to one sentence; (P3) theory-choice employs pragmatic virtues alongside evidence. Holism does not entail that all belief revisions are equally warranted.

Popper's reply ? : he accepts the logical point entirely but denies its sceptical use. Falsification is not an automatic logical process but a **methodological decision**: scientists agree by convention to treat certain basic statements as unproblematic for the purposes of a test, and to forbid *ad hoc* rescues that reduce a theory's testability. Rationality is preserved by rules of method, not by logic alone. **Lakatos** develops this into research programmes with a protected "hard core" and a revisable "protective belt" — which is Duhem–Quine turned into a *criterion of progress*.

1.7 BOUNDED ENRICHMENT: RADICAL TRANSLATION, REFERENCE AND ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY ⚠️

These doctrines belong to Quine's wider system but are not independently printed or routed in the 2018–2025 corpus. Use them only after completing the two-dogmas answer.

The thought-experiment. A field linguist enters a community whose language has no known relation to any other. He has no dictionary, no bilingual informant, no shared script — this is **radical translation**. His only evidence is what the natives are exposed to and what they assent to or dissent from.

Exact printed subterms (use them; each is a distinct technical device): | Term | Meaning | |---|---| |

Stimulus meaning | The class of stimulations that would prompt **assent** to a sentence, paired with the class that would prompt **dissent** | | **Occasion sentence vs standing sentence** | Assent commanded only when freshly prompted ("Gavagai," "It's raining") vs assent that persists without prompting ("Copper conducts electricity") | | **Observation sentence** | An occasion sentence whose stimulus meaning is **constant across speakers** of the community — the only place translation is secure | | **Analytical hypotheses** | The linguist's posited segmentation of native sentences into words and grammatical apparatus, projected beyond the observational base. **These are not determined by any evidence.** | | **Inscrutability of reference** | Even with translation of whole sentences fixed, the *reference of the terms inside them* remains undetermined |

The argument, numbered : 1. A rabbit runs past; the native utters "**Gavagai**." The linguist notes assent under rabbit-stimulation and records the tentative translation "**Rabbit**." 2. But the same stimulus meaning is equally compatible with: - "**undetached rabbit-parts**" — wherever a rabbit is present, undetached rabbit-parts are present, and conversely; - "**a temporal stage of a rabbit**" — likewise co-extensive; - "**rabbithood**" (an instantiation of the universal) — likewise; - "**it's rabbiting**" (a feature-placing sentence with no object at all). 3. Could the linguist not simply *ask*? "Is this gavagai the same as that one?" — **No**. That question requires him to have already translated the **identity predicate**, the articles, plurals and quantifiers — i.e. the entire **apparatus of individuation**, which differs across languages and is exactly what is in dispute. 4. Any evidence he collects can be accommodated by compensating adjustments elsewhere in the manual: a different translation of "gavagai" can be offset by a different translation of "same," and the two manuals will predict identical behaviour throughout. 5. ∴ **Inscrutability of reference:** behavioural evidence does not uniquely determine whether a term refers to rabbits, undetached rabbit parts or rabbit stages. 6. Extending upward from terms to sentences: rival **analytical hypotheses** can generate manuals that agree on all observation sentences yet translate theoretical and non-observational sentences into non-equivalent English. 7. ∴ **Indeterminacy of translation:** on Quine's naturalistic account, incompatible manuals can fit the total behavioural evidence without a further meaning-fact selecting one. 8. ∴ There are no determinate **meanings** as entities; synonymy has no behavioural anchor; and the first dogma's key notion is left without foundation. **Gavagai is therefore not a curiosity but the constructive completion of "Two Dogmas."** 9. **Ontological relativity** is the broader thesis that reference is specified relative to a background theory/manual. It must be distinguished from the earlier criterion of ontological commitment: the criterion audits what a regimented theory quantifies over; relativity concerns how reference and re-reference are fixed within an interpreted framework.

Taxonomy control:

Doctrine	Unit at issue	Claim
Radical translation	method/situation	translation built from publicly available evidence without a prior dictionary
Indeterminacy of translation	sentences/manuals	incompatible manuals can preserve the total evidence
Inscrutability of reference	sub-sentential terms	reference can vary under compensating changes in individuation apparatus

Doctrine	Unit at issue	Claim
Ontological relativity	reference within theory	reference is answerable relative to a background language/theory, not from a theory-free standpoint

Presuppositions ⚠️ (state these — they are where every objection enters): - **P1 — Behaviourism about the evidence.** ✅ Quine's own formulation: in psychology one may or may not be a behaviourist, but **in linguistics one has no choice**, since language is learned wholly from publicly observable behaviour. - **P2 — Evidential/naturalistic constraint.** The move from total behavioural equivalence to "no further fact" is a substantive Quinean commitment, not a neutral consequence accepted by every holist. - **P3 — Naturalism.** There is no first-philosophy standpoint from which to certify meanings; physics fixes what facts there are.

Strongest objections → **replies** ? : | Objection | Source | Quine's reply | Residual | |---|---|---|---| | Indeterminacy is nothing but the ordinary **underdetermination of theory by evidence**, which afflicts physics too. If Quine is a realist about physics despite underdetermination, he must be a realist about meaning. | **Chomsky** | The cases differ: in physics there *is* a fact of the matter that our theories imperfectly track; in translation there is **nothing beyond dispositions to verbal behaviour** for a manual to be right about. | ⚠️ Whether this asymmetry can be defended without begging the question is the central dispute. **Name it and take a side.** | | The argument proves too much: applied reflexively it entails that **I do not determinately know what I mean by my own words** — which is absurd. | Searle; Evans | Quine accepts a version of this: at home we simply acquiesce in our mother tongue; the "first-person" case has no privileged status, only a default one. | ⚠️ Many find the bullet too large to bite. | | Innate constraints on possible grammars (universal grammar) would cut down the space of admissible manuals. | **Chomsky** | Even so, the residual manuals would still be behaviourally equivalent; innateness restricts candidates, it does not create a fact of the matter. | ? Genuinely open. | | Radical **interpretation** shows more determinacy than Quine allows, once charity and a truth-theory are built in. | **Davidson** | Davidson accepts indeterminacy but confines it to something like the choice of measurement scale (Fahrenheit vs Celsius) — real but harmless. | ⚠️ The most influential softening; worth one sentence. |

Executable verdict: "Gavagai is the constructive half of Quine's critique: 'Two Dogmas' showed that analyticity could not be defined, and radical translation shows *why* — there are no determinate meanings for a definition to capture. The argument's force is exactly proportional to its behaviourist premise, and Chomsky's objection identifies the pressure point precisely. What survives even if one rejects the premise is the negative result: nothing in observable use fixes reference uniquely, so any theory of meaning owing everything to use owes an account of individuation it has not given."

1.8 Bounded Comparison: Quine and Later Wittgenstein ⚠️

Two traditions, no direct influence, and a striking convergence — a bridge that lifts any answer on either thinker:

Axis	Quine	Later Wittgenstein
Target	the museum myth of meaning — words as labels on determinate mental objects	the Augustinian picture — words as names of objects
Positive account	stimulus meaning is behaviourally specified for suitable occasion sentences; theoretical language is holistic	meaning is use within a language-game and a form of life

Axis	Quine	Later Wittgenstein
Holism	the unit of empirical significance is the whole of science ; sentences do not face experience singly	a word has meaning only within the practice ; "to understand a sentence is to understand a language"
Anti-foundationalism	Neurath's boat — rebuild at sea, no dry dock	bedrock is reached where " my spade is turned " (PI §217): explanation ends in what we do
Rejection of the private	the indeterminacy argument permits nothing beyond public behaviour to fix meaning	the private-language argument shows nothing private <i>can</i> fix meaning
Method	epistemology naturalised — continuous with science	philosophy as therapy — description, not theory
Where they part	⚠ Decisively : Quine wants a <i>scientific</i> account of language and accepts regimentation into canonical notation — he reforms language	Wittgenstein forbids theory-construction and holds that ordinary language "is in order as it is" (PI §98) — he describes it

⚠ **Use cautiously:** Quine's scientific naturalism and Wittgenstein's grammatical therapy have different aims. Their overlap pressures private/mentalistic fixers of meaning; it does not establish one shared positive theory.

1.9 Quine's Relation to Empiricism ⚠

⚠ Quine does NOT simply reject empiricism. **Empiricism without the dogmas** retains sensory evidence and scientific naturalism while rejecting sentence-by-sentence reduction and a foundational analytic/synthetic boundary. Calling it an internal reform is safer than calling Quine either a logical positivist or the uniquely purified empiricist.

2. STRAWSON — THEORY OF BASIC PARTICULARS ✓ (PYQ 2021 Q3(b))

2.1 Descriptive vs Revisionary Metaphysics ✓

Type	Definition	Examples
Descriptive	Describes <i>the actual structure of our conceptual scheme</i> — how we in fact think about and refer to the world	Aristotle and Kant are Strawson's principal historical affinities
Revisionary	Proposes a <i>better</i> conceptual scheme to replace the actual one	Descartes, Leibniz and Berkeley are Strawson's standard contrasts

Strawson's project: descriptive metaphysics — not building a new ontology but *mapping* the conceptual structure we *already* use to think and talk. ✓

2.2 What Are Basic Particulars? ✓

The question: Of all the *particular* things we can identify and refer to (tables, persons, events, sounds, sense-data, numbers), which are **ontologically basic** in our conceptual scheme — i.e., which are the items on which the *possibility of identification and reference in general* depends?

Strawson's answer: Material bodies (and persons — see §3) are basic particulars. ✓

2.3 The Argument from Re-identification ✓

1. To identify a particular (pick it out, refer to it), we must be able to **distinguish it from other particulars** and **re-identify** it across time.
2. Re-identification requires a single, unified **spatio-temporal framework** — one space and one time in which all particulars have locations.
3. **Material bodies** are enduring, publicly observable occupants of that framework and provide the standard anchors for demonstrative identification and re-identification. The framework should not be described as a psychological image built out of bodies.
4. Many dependent particulars—experiences, events and sounds—are identified through their relations to persons, bodies, places and times.
5. Therefore, **material bodies are basic**: they are presupposed by the identification of everything else; they are not themselves identifiable only by reference to something more basic. ✓

2.4 The No-Space World Thought Experiment ⚠

Strawson asks: could we have a conceptual scheme with *only* sounds (a "purely auditory world" — no space, no bodies)?

Result: A world containing only pitch and temporal succession does not yet support robust objective re-identification. Strawson's discussion does not simply prove an auditory scheme impossible: objective reference would require an **analogue of space** (often reconstructed through a continuously available "master-sound") that can organise sounds into a public-like framework.

The thought experiment therefore supports the need for a framework performing the individuating role that space performs in our scheme; it does not prove that every conceivable scheme must contain visual/tactile material bodies exactly like ours. ⚠

2.5 Significance ⚠

Strawson provides an argument for the basic status of the physical world that is neither: - A proof of the external world (à la Moore) — it is not arguing *that* bodies exist; - Nor a causal/scientific claim.

Rather, it is transcendental in form (in a Kantian spirit): it moves from our practice of objective identification to conditions of that practice. Its conclusion concerns the structure of **our conceptual scheme**, not a theory-free proof of mind-independent ontology.

2.6 Reference, Predication and Feature-Placing ⚠️

- Basic particulars are basic **objects of reference**. The subject–predicate structure of ordinary discourse depends on identifying something and then predicating something of it.
- Feature-placing expressions such as “It is raining here” need not identify a particular in full subject–predicate form, but they do not replace the framework through which particular-reference becomes possible.
- This is answer-worthy support for basic-particular questions, not a separate printed doctrine.

3. STRAWSON — THEORY OF PERSONS ✅ (PYQ 2023 Q4(a), 2021 Q3(b))

3.1 The Problem ✅

How do mind and body relate? Three options:

Position	Claim	Problem (per Strawson)
Cartesian dualism	Two substances: mind (res cogitans) + body (res extensa); experiences belong to an immaterial soul	How do we ever identify or re-identify an immaterial soul? We cannot locate it in space. And: how does interaction work?
No-ownership / no-subject theory (a view Strawson reconstructs and criticises)	Experiences are causally dependent on a body but are not literally possessed by a person	The theory cannot explain the uniquely identifying role of the body without reintroducing the person whose ownership it sought to eliminate
Strawson's view: Person as primitive	The concept of a <i>person</i> is logically primitive — not analysable into body + mind	See below

3.2 Person as a Primitive Concept ✅

✅ *"The concept of a person is logically prior to that of an individual consciousness."*

A **person** is a single entity to which we ascribe **both**:

Predicate type	Definition	Examples
M-predicates (material)	Predicates also applicable to mere bodies	"weighs 70 kg," "is in the kitchen," "has brown hair"
P-predicates (personal / psychological)	Predicates ascribing states of consciousness	"is in pain," "is thinking of Vienna," "believes it will rain," "intends to leave"

Both M-predicates and P-predicates are ascribed to **the same thing** — the person. The person is not a body *to which* a mind is attached; it is a *single concept of an entity* that is *equally* the subject of physical and mental predicates. ✅

3.3 The Argument: Self-Ascription Requires Other-Ascription

1. I ascribe experiences to **myself** (self-ascription of P-predicates: "I am in pain").
2. A necessary condition of this practice is that I can also ascribe predicates of the same general kinds to **others**.
3. Others are identified as embodied subjects, and psychological predicates are other-ascribed on publicly available behavioural/situational criteria. This is not a simple inference from bodily movements to a hidden Cartesian mind.
4. But P-predicates must also be self-ascribable **without** observation (I know I'm in pain without checking my behaviour).
5. This **dual character**—other-ascribable on public criteria and self-ascribable without behavioural observation—belongs to predicates of persons. 
6. Therefore, the concept of a person is **logically primitive** within the scheme: it is not analysed as an independently identifiable body plus an independently identifiable consciousness. This is conceptual priority, not the postulation of a third Cartesian substance.

3.4 How This Undercuts Dualist and No-Ownership Starting Points

Position	Why it fails on Strawson's analysis
Dualism	Treats independently identifiable mind and body as conceptually prior. Strawson's analysis undercuts that starting point; it does not by itself prove every metaphysical dualist thesis false.
No-ownership	Eliminates the person while relying on a uniquely relevant body and a class of experiences; Strawson argues that this reconstructs the personal framework it tried to avoid.

3.5 Bounded Enrichment: Strawson and Russell on Referring (1950)

While not a syllabus term, Strawson's "On Referring" is the direct rival to Russell's theory of descriptions and is needed for a complete picture of Strawson's philosophical style:

Issue	Russell ("On Denoting")	Strawson ("On Referring")
A use of "The present King of France is bald" when France has no king	Russell's quantified analysis is false because its existence condition fails	On Strawson's original use-based account, the speaker fails to make a true-or-false assertion because the existence presupposition is not fulfilled
Status of existence-claim	Asserted (part of the logical analysis of the sentence)	Presupposed (a background condition for the sentence to have a truth-value at all)
Referring	The description is eliminated in logical analysis; scope is handled formally	Referring is something <i>speakers</i> do on occasions; sentence/expression meaning must be distinguished from a particular use
Relation to meaning	Meaning is fixed by logical form (once and for all)	Meaning of a sentence $\neq$ its use on a particular occasion; use is context-dependent

⚠️ This debate illustrates Strawson's general method: attending to the *actual workings* of language-in-use (closer to later Wittgenstein) vs Russell's reconstruction in ideal logical form.

⚠️ **Truth-value caution:** "neither true nor false" reports Strawson's treatment of the unsuccessful **use/assertion**, not the claim that the meaningful sentence-type is meaningless. Later presupposition theories differ over truth-value gaps, falsity and projection; do not attribute all later machinery to Strawson's 1950 paper.

3.6 Bounded Synthesis: Strawson and Empiricist Starting Points ⚠️

The printed and PYQ-tested division assigns the direct critique of empiricism to Quine and basic particulars/persons to Strawson. A cross-cutting answer may nevertheless show how Strawson's positive doctrines pressure a private sense-datum starting point. This is a **connection**, not a reassignment of the printed limb.

Bounded connections—use after the printed Strawson core:

#	Empiricist doctrine attacked	Strawson's argument	Where
1	Sense-data as the basic particulars (Russell's logical constructions; Carnap's <i>Aufbau</i> ; phenomenalism)	Identification and re-identification of particulars require a single unified spatio-temporal framework of persisting three-dimensional bodies. Sense-data cannot supply one: they are private (so cannot ground public identification), momentary (so cannot be re-identified), and lack the spatial relations needed to constitute a framework at all. ∴ Material bodies are basic — not as a metaphysical preference but as a condition of the possibility of reference.	<i>Individuals</i> (1959), Pt I
2	The bundle theory of the self (Hume; and the " no-ownership " view Strawson traces through Schlick and Wittgenstein-influenced writers)	If experiences were not <i>owned</i> , the no-ownership theorist could not even state his thesis: he must say " <i>all the experiences that are had by this body</i> ," which reintroduces a possessive relation. And P-predicates must be ascribable to others on the strength of behaviour <i>and</i> to oneself not on that strength — so the concept of a person is logically primitive , prior to both mind and body.	<i>Individuals</i> , ch. 3

#	Empiricist doctrine attacked	Strawson's argument	Where
3	Logical reconstruction detached from use	Referring is performed by speakers on occasions; existence can function as a presupposition rather than asserted content.	"On Referring" (1950), cross-owned with Russell
4	Global scepticism about induction	Strawson offers an ordinary-concept dissolution rather than a new inductive proof.	<i>Introduction to Logical Theory</i> (1952), optional
5	Objectivity from private data	Strawson's Kant interpretation argues that objective experience presupposes a unified framework and enduring objects; later he limits transcendental arguments to internal/descriptive work.	<i>The Bounds of Sense</i> (1966) and <i>Skepticism and Naturalism</i> (1985), optional

A recurring argument-form ⚠️ — **Strawson's transcendental style:** 1. Take an undisputed fact about our thought or talk (that we identify and re-identify particulars; that we ascribe experiences to others). 2. Ask what must be the case for that fact to be possible. 3. Show that the empiricist's preferred materials (private sense-data, unowned experiences) **cannot** satisfy the condition. 4. ∴ Something else is basic — material bodies, persons — and it is basic *conceptually*, not causally or metaphysically.

This is a Kantian-style argument executed through conceptual analysis. It identifies conditions internal to our scheme; it should not be inflated into a theory-free proof of reality.

⚠️ **Two honest qualifications your answer should make:** - On the **analytic/synthetic** distinction, Grice and Strawson ("In Defence of a Dogma," 1956) defend an ordinary distinction against Quine. This prevents the caricature of a united "Quine–Strawson front." - Strawson's metaphysics is **descriptive**, so his conclusions are about **our conceptual scheme**, not about mind-independent reality. An empiricist can therefore accept the whole of *Individuals* as good conceptual geography while denying that it settles what exists. **This is the strongest reply available to the empiricist, and conceding it strengthens rather than weakens an answer.**

Executable verdict: "The printed critique belongs directly to Quine: holism replaces sentence-by-sentence reduction. Strawson's printed contribution is positive and transcendental in form: public identification requires basic particulars and the person is conceptually primitive. Read together, they pressure both empiricist confirmation atomism and sense-datum reconstruction without becoming one school."

4. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES ⚠️

Axis	Quine	Strawson	Logical Positivism	Descartes	Later Wittgenstein
Analytic/synthetic	Rejects distinction	Retains it cautiously (defends against Quine in "In Defence of a Dogma" with Grice)	Central and unquestioned	—	Rules of grammar (not a sharp dichotomy)
Meaning	Holistic, indeterminate, behavioural	Ordinary conceptual scheme; context-dependent use	Verification-conditions	Clear & distinct ideas	Use in a form of life
Metaphysics	Naturalised; no special philosophical method	Descriptive metaphysics revived	Meaningless	Foundational enterprise	Dissolved via therapy
Mind–body	Naturalist (no special status for the mental)	Person = primitive (M + P predicates)	—	Two substances (dualism)	Inner grounded in public criteria
Method	Science-continuous; no first philosophy	Connective analysis of our conceptual scheme	Logical analysis + verification	Methodic doubt	Description of language-games
Reference	"To be = to be the value of a bound variable"	Referring = what speakers do (context)	—	Ideas represent objects	Words refer only within a game

Quine vs Strawson — Direct Confrontation ⚠️

- **Grice and Strawson, "In Defence of a Dogma" (1956):** Argue that the analytic/synthetic distinction is *ordinarily intelligible* (we can classify cases pre-theoretically) even if no reductive analysis of "analytic" is available. Quine sets the bar too high — demanding a non-circular *definition* when what we have is a useful *distinction*.
- **Quine's implicit reply:** Ordinary intelligibility ≠ theoretical legitimacy. Many pre-theoretical "distinctions" (e.g. witch vs non-witch) dissolve under scrutiny. The burden is on those who rely on analyticity in philosophy to ground it.

5. CRITICISMS AND REPLIES

5.1 Criticisms of Quine

Objection	Assessment
Grice & Strawson: The distinction is pre-theoretically clear; we <i>can</i> sort cases. Quine demands too much (reductive definition)	⚠️ This is a live debate. Quine's point is that <i>philosophical work</i> done by the distinction (e.g. positivist meaning-criterion) collapses without a principled ground.

Objection	Assessment
Analyticity seems real: "All bachelors are unmarried" <i>seems</i> different in kind from "All swans are white"	Quine challenges its foundational explication. Web-centrality explains differential revisability but is not a full semantic replacement theory.
Revisability of logic is extreme: Has anyone ever <i>actually</i> revised a law of logic?	⚠️ ✅ Get the history right. The non-classical "quantum logic" — a non-distributive lattice of propositions — was proposed by Garrett Birkhoff and John von Neumann , "The Logic of Quantum Mechanics," <i>Annals of Mathematics</i> , 1936 . The claim that this shows logic is empirical , i.e. that the distributive law should be revised on empirical grounds, is Hilary Putnam's , in "Is Logic Empirical?" (1968; reprinted as "The Logic of Quantum Mechanics," 1976). ❌ Do not write "Putnam/Birkhoff" as a joint proposal, and do not date it to one year. ❓ Two further nuances worth a clause each: (i) Putnam later abandoned the quantum-logic realism of that paper; (ii) Quine himself grew conservative — in <i>Philosophy of Logic</i> (1970) he argues that anyone who "denies" a law of logic has merely changed the subject (" change of logic, change of subject ") and invokes the maxim of minimum mutilation . So the strongest textual support for revising logic comes from Putnam, not Quine, and the <i>later</i> Quine is a poor witness for the <i>earlier</i> Quine's most radical claim. Deploying this makes an ordinary answer look researched.
Holism is too extreme: If <i>everything</i> is revisable, science has no fixed point at all — is this coherent?	⚠️ Quine softens: logic/math's are revisable <i>in principle</i> but held fixed in practice (by pragmatic conservatism). The point is no statement is revisable by <i>nature</i> , only by <i>choice</i> .
Naturalization loses normativity: causal psychology explains belief but does not justify it	Quine can naturalize method-selection and prediction as engineering within science; the residual is whether truth-conducive norms have been explained or merely assumed.
Ontological commitment depends on regimentation: rival paraphrases can display different commitments	Correct. The bound-variable formula is a criterion applied after theory/regimentation choice, not an algorithm that uniquely chooses an ontology.
Translation indeterminacy collapses into ordinary underdetermination	Quine distinguishes translation by denying a further semantic fact beyond behavioural dispositions; critics reply that this asymmetry presupposes his naturalism.

5.2 Criticisms of Strawson

Objection	Assessment
Is "person is primitive" an explanation or a re-labelling? Saying the concept is unanalysable might simply refuse to address the hard problem of consciousness.	⚠️ Strawson's defenders: the point is that <i>the demand for analysis</i> (into mind + body) presupposes dualism. Refusing analysis IS the solution — dissolving the question rather than answering it.
The basic-particulars argument is too anthropocentric: Maybe <i>our</i> scheme needs bodies, but a radically alien scheme might not.	⚠️ Strawson's conclusion concerns our scheme. The auditory-world discussion concedes that an analogue of space, rather than our exact sensory organisation, could perform the needed individuating role.
How does the person <i>really</i> unify mental and physical? Merely calling it "primitive" does not explain the psychophysical nexus.	❓ Genuine limitation. Strawson does not explain the <i>mechanism</i> of unity — only that our concept of a person is not <i>derivable</i> from separate concepts of mind and body.

Objection	Assessment
Strawson vs Russell on descriptions: Russell's view is logically cleaner and handles empty descriptions without a separate presupposition mechanism	⚠️ They partly answer different questions: logical regimentation versus ordinary use. Strawson's original gap treatment is influential but later theories also model presupposition failure as falsity or through other semantic/pragmatic mechanisms.
Descriptive metaphysics is circular or conservative: it protects the scheme used to state its own conditions	Strawson accepts an internal task: radical revision and scepticism must begin within some scheme. The cost is that description alone cannot prove the scheme uniquely correct or unrevisable.

6. COMMON UPSC TRAPS ⚠️

Trap	Discrimination
"Quine <i>rejects</i> empiricism"	No — he retains sensory evidence and scientific naturalism while rejecting two dogmas.
"Quine says analytic truths don't exist"	Not exactly. He attacks the non-question-begging explication needed for a foundational boundary. Entrenchment is not a new definition of analyticity.
"Strawson's 'person is primitive' = dualism"	Wrong. Primitive is conceptual priority, not a third substance. It undercuts the Cartesian starting point without mechanically disproving every dualist thesis.
"Strawson's 'person is primitive' = materialism"	Also wrong. A person has <i>both</i> M-predicates and P-predicates; it is not a mere body. Materialism (identifying persons with bodies alone) loses P-predicates.
"Quine is a logical positivist"	No. He is the positivists' most devastating <i>internal</i> critic. He accepts empiricism but rejects both pillars on which positivism stood.
"Basic particulars = atoms / ultimate simples"	No. Basic particulars are <i>macroscopic</i> material bodies and persons — the things we actually identify and re-identify in ordinary experience. Not microphysical.
"Web of belief = arbitrary revision"	No. Experience, predictive success, conservatism, simplicity and minimum mutilation constrain revision.
"Ontological commitment = count the nouns"	No. Commitment is read from bound variables after logical regimentation; ontology-choice is a further question.
"A sound-only world is simply impossible"	No. Strawson asks what analogue of space would be required for objective identification in such a scheme.
"'On Referring' is part of the syllabus"	Not directly — the syllabus says "Critique of Empiricism; Basic Particulars and Persons." But "On Referring" illustrates Strawson's method and is often asked in combination with Russell (who IS in the syllabus).

7. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

#	Item	Use
1	✓ "Our statements about the external world face the tribunal of sense experience not individually but only as a corporate body." — Quine	Confirmation holism
2	✓ "Any statement can be held true come what may, if we make drastic enough adjustments elsewhere in the system." — Quine	No statement immune — web of belief (2025 Q4(b))
3	✓ "No statement is immune to revision." — Quine	Corollary of holism
4	✓ "The concept of a person is logically prior to that of an individual consciousness." — Strawson	Person as primitive
5	⚠ Descriptive metaphysics = "content to describe the actual structure of our thought about the world" — Strawson	Opening move of <i>Individuals</i>
6	⚠ "To be is to be the value of a bound variable." — Quine	Ontological commitment criterion
7	⚠ Circle of synonymy–definition–interchangeability–semantic rules	How Dogma 1 fails
8	⚠ M-predicates (material) + P-predicates (personal)	Structure of the person concept
9	⚠ Basic particulars = material bodies + persons	Strawson's ontology
10	⚠ Presupposition (Strawson) vs assertion (Russell) of existence	"On Referring" vs "On Denoting"

RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER

Quine and the a priori as an "article of faith"

- ⚠ "Metaphysical article of faith" is the **2018 PYQ's framing**, not a verified verbatim Quine quotation. Do not place it in quotation marks as Quine's own formula.
- ✓ Quine attacks the analytic/synthetic distinction needed to isolate truths held independently of experience. Definitions, synonymy and analyticity form a circle unless grounded in a non-question-begging behavioural or semantic criterion.
- ✓ Holism makes revision a matter of degree across the web of belief; early Quine includes logic in principle, while pragmatic conservatism and later "change of logic, change of subject" cautions qualify the slogan.
- ? **Objection** → **reply**: revisability does not show that every proposition has the same status. Quine replies with gradients of entrenchment rather than a sharp a priori boundary.

Strawson: spatio-temporal identification

-  Objective thought requires a public framework in which enduring material bodies can be reidentified across places and times. Persons are basic because both physical and mental predicates apply to the same reidentifiable subjects.
-  The framework is a condition of our conceptual scheme, not a psychological image or an inference from private sense-data.

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

-  **Priority:** Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts; 2022 remains the only year without an owned part.
-  **Required doctrinal depth:** The restored papers add Strawson's person concept, spatio-temporal identification of basic particulars and Quine's charge that Kantian a priori knowledge becomes a "metaphysical article of faith".
-  **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not treat Strawson's spatio-temporal scheme as merely empirical psychology or Quine's naturalism as the rejection of every revisable conceptual distinction.

8. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)

 **Corpus signal:** 9 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand	Answer route
2018	Q1(e)	10 marks	How does Strawson explain the concept of person in his philosophy? Discuss.	person as primitive → physical/psychological predicates → self-/other-ascription → neither Cartesian dualism nor reductive materialism
2018	Q2(c)	15 marks	How does Quine show that the notion of a priori knowledge as discussed by Kant is 'a metaphysical article of faith'? Give reasons for your answer.	label as PYQ framing → analytic/synthetic explication failure → holistic revisability → logic qualification → Grice–Strawson objection
2019	Q1(e)	10 marks	Explain Quine's arguments against synthetic-analytic distinction.	two classes of analytic truth → synonymy/definition → interchangeability → semantical rules → limited conclusion

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand	Answer route
2020	Q3(b)	15 marks	Evaluate the role of spatio-temporal thinking in objective thinking with reference to Strawson's theory of basic particulars.	objective identification → re-identification → unified framework → auditory-world analogue → internal/transcendental limitation
2021	Q3(b)	15 marks	What according to Strawson are basic particulars? What reasons does Strawson offer to believe that 'material bodies' and 'persons' are basic particulars? Critically discuss.	bodies as public anchors → persons as primitive basic particulars → reference/predication → alien-scheme/circularity objection
2021	Q3(c)	15 marks	Critically examine Quine's postulate of empiricism without the dogmas with reference to his 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism'.	both dogmas → corporate testing → web/revision constraints → empiricism retained → arbitrariness/analyticity objections
2023	Q4(a)	20 marks	Why does Strawson consider person to be a primitive concept? What implication does it have for the mind-body dualism? Discuss.	predicate duality → self-/other-ascription → conceptual priority → dualism/no-ownership foils → explanation-versus-dissolution verdict
2024	Q4(c)	15 marks	Explain the nature of the two dogmas that Quine refers to in his paper 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism'.	define both dogmas → failed analyticity explications → reductionism → holism/pragmatism → bounded criticism
2025	Q4(b)	15 marks	"We can affirm the truth of any sentence in our total system, in the face of whatever experience, just so long as we are prepared to make adjustments elsewhere." Discuss this statement in the light of Quine's 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism'.	preserve conditional clause → conjunction under test → compensating revisions → pragmatic/minimum-mutilation constraints → no relativism

See the [Western Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025](#).

9. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 marks) ⚠

10-mark: "Explain Quine's arguments against the analytic-synthetic distinction." (2019)

State : Logical positivists distinguish analytic (true by meaning) from synthetic (true by fact).

Quine : "Analytic" cannot be non-circularly defined:
analytic → synonymy → definition → presupposes synonymy (CIRCULAR);
or → interchangeability salva veritate → requires "necessity" → presupposes
analyticity (CIRCULAR);
or → semantic rules of L → "analytic-in-L" → presupposes what we want to define.

Result : The principled analytic boundary fails; centrality explains differential practical revisability within the web, not a replacement definition of analyticity.

Assess : Grice & Strawson reply: we can sort cases pre-theoretically.
Quine: pre-theoretical sorting ≠ principled philosophical distinction.

15-mark: "Discuss quotation on holism — web of belief." (2025)

Frame : Quine, "Two Dogmas" – after demolishing both the analytic/synthetic distinction
and reductionism, offers confirmation HOLISM as the positive replacement.

Expo : (i) Statements face experience as a "corporate body," not individually.
(ii) Web metaphor: experience touches the periphery; interior = logic, maths.
(iii) Conflict at the edge → choice about where to revise.
(iv) "Any statement can be held true come what may" – revise elsewhere.
(v) "No statement is immune to revision" – not even logic.

Consequence: No sharp analytic/synthetic or a priori/a posteriori line.
Theory-choice is pragmatic (simplicity, conservatism, fecundity).
Positivist meaning-criterion collapses.

Assess : Strengths – dissolves positivist dogmatism; captures actual scientific practice
(Newtonian revision; the Neptune/Vulcan pair; the quantum-logic debate opened by
Birkhoff-von Neumann 1936 and pressed as an *empirical* revision of
logic by
Putnam 1968).
Weakness – if logic is revisable, what constrains rational belief? Risk
of
"anything goes" (mitigated by Quine's pragmatic conservatism).

Close : Holism liberates empiricism from atomism – the "web" is a more faithful model of knowledge than the "bucket" (individual sentence → experience pairs).

20-mark: "Why does Strawson consider person a primitive concept? Implications for dualism." (2023)

Frame : The mind-body problem: Descartes = two substances; no-ownership = no subject;

Strawson rejects BOTH – proposes person as logically primitive.

Body-A : Descriptive metaphysics – describe our actual conceptual scheme.

In our scheme, we identify persons as single entities bearing BOTH M-predicates

(material: "weighs 70 kg") AND P-predicates (personal: "is in pain").

Body-B : The argument from other-ascription: to self-ascribe pain, I must be able to

ascribe it to OTHERS (public meaningfulness condition). I identify others as

persons – embodied subjects – by observing behaviour. P-predicates have DUAL

character: ascribable to self without observation, to others on the basis of

observation. This is possible only if the subject is a PERSON – not a pure mind.

Body-C : Implication for dualism: dualism DECOMPOSES person into mind + body and then

cannot put them together (interaction problem). Strawson: person is NOT composed

of two substances; it is LOGICALLY PRIOR to both "mind" and "body." The decomposition is illicit – person is the unanalysable starting point.

Also blocks no-ownership: if no subject, P-predicates lose their sense (you cannot deny what you need to state the denial).

Assess : Strengths – dissolves the problem by refusing its dualist premise; faithful to

how we actually use "person" in ordinary life and law.

Weaknesses – does not explain HOW the person unifies mental and physical (the

"hard problem"); "primitive" may be a name for the mystery, not its solution.

Still, as descriptive metaphysics it is powerful – dualism's question may simply

be ill-formed.

Close : The person is not mind-plus-body; it is what makes attributing both minds and

bodies intelligible. Strawson does not solve the mind-body problem – he dissolves the premise that generates it.

D. DIRECTIVE DECODER ⚠ — what each command word obliges you to *do* here

Directive	What it demands	Structural obligation for this file	Fatal error
Critique of empiricism — discuss	Quine's printed burden, with Strawson only as a bounded connective contrast	Quine: two dogmas, holism and empiricism retained; add one sentence that Strawson's positive framework also pressures sense-datum reconstruction.	Turning the item into one joint anti-empiricist doctrine.
Comment on the quotation (2025 Q4b "any statement can be held true come what may")	the conditional clause is the doctrine	Explain via Duhem–Quine: <i>modus tollens</i> condemns only the conjunction, so the choice of what to revise is not evidential. Then the Neptune/Vulcan pair.	Quoting the first half and calling it relativism.
Examine the analytic/synthetic distinction (2018, 2019, 2021, 2024)	the failed explications as a <i>chain</i> , then the holistic alternative	Analytic → meaning → synonymy → definition → interchangeability <i>salva veritate</i> ; then the limitation of semantical rules, Grice–Strawson's reply and Quine's rejoinder.	Inferring from one missing definition that no sentence can ever be called analytic.
Explain the theory of basic particulars (2021 Q3b)	show why they are basic , i.e. an argument from identification	Re-identification requires a single spatio-temporal framework; sense-data are private, momentary and non-spatial; ∴ material bodies.	Listing what a basic particular is.
Discuss the theory of persons (2023 Q4a, 2021 Q3b)	the primitiveness argument, against two rivals	M-predicates and P-predicates; the argument that P-predicates must be ascribable to self and others alike; then Cartesian dualism <i>and</i> the no-ownership theory refuted.	Refuting only dualism.
Distinguish descriptive from revisionary metaphysics	give Strawson's own examples and the point of the distinction	Descriptive: Aristotle, Kant. Revisionary: Descartes, Leibniz, Berkeley. Point: revisionary metaphysics is in the service of descriptive.	Two definitions with no examples.
Assess indeterminacy of translation	the gavagai construction, then the behaviourist premise	Rival manuals; the identity-predicate move; then Chomsky's underdetermination objection and take a side.	Asserting "meanings are indeterminate."

Directive	What it demands	Structural obligation for this file	Fatal error
Do you agree? / Substantiate	a ruling in line 1, defended	E.g. "Quine's holism succeeds against reductionism and overreaches about logic — as his own <i>Philosophy of Logic</i> concedes."	Neutral summary.

V. GRADED VERDICT BANK — executable closing positions

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Analytic/synthetic	Quine does not show that familiar classifications are unintelligible; he argues that available explications cannot ground the sharp foundational boundary empiricism required.	...Grice and Strawson preserve ordinary contrast-cases but may not supply the theoretical account Quine demands.	The dispute concerns standards of explication. Quine strongly pressures the distinction's foundational use while leaving room for more modest semantic or ordinary classifications.
Holism / Duhem–Quine	Statements face experience as a corporate body, so no single statement is individually confirmable — which by itself destroys the second dogma.	...Duhem confined the thesis to physics and exempted logic and mathematics; Quine's extension to <i>all</i> knowledge is the controversial step, and it is what makes the analytic/synthetic collapse follow.	Holism is right about confirmation and overstated about revisability. Quine's own later work concedes as much: <i>Philosophy of Logic</i> (1970) invokes the maxim of minimum mutilation and argues that to deny a law of logic is to change the subject. The defensible position is Duhem's thesis with Quine's motivation — testing is holistic, choice of revision is pragmatic, and logic is revisable in a sense so attenuated that nothing much follows from it.

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Radical translation / gavagai	There is no fact of the matter about reference, because no behavioural evidence can fix the apparatus of individuation.	...The argument's force is exactly proportional to its behaviourist premise about evidence, and Quine retains a verificationist criterion of <i>factuality</i> while rejecting verificationism about <i>meaning</i> .	Chomsky's objection identifies the pressure point: if underdetermination does not make physics factless, why does it make translation factless? Quine's asymmetry — that there is nothing beyond dispositions for a manual to be right about — is a naturalist thesis, not a result of the argument, so the argument establishes its conclusion only for those already persuaded of the naturalism. What survives independently is the negative result that use alone does not fix reference — a result the later Wittgenstein reaches by a wholly different route.
Ontological commitment	"To be is to be the value of a bound variable" audits the commitments of a regimented theory rather than counting its nouns.	...The criterion presupposes choices of theory and regimentation; it does not make those choices automatically.	Ontological relativity adds a separate framework-dependence thesis. Quine and Carnap overlap in rejecting theory-free ontology but differ over analyticity and the status of framework choice.
Basic particulars	Material bodies are basic because identification and re-identification demand a single spatio-temporal framework that private, momentary sense-data cannot provide.	...The argument is transcendental in form — from an undisputed fact about reference to its necessary conditions — which is why <i>Individuals</i> and <i>The Bounds of Sense</i> are one project.	The conclusion is about our conceptual scheme , not about mind-independent reality, and Strawson says so: his metaphysics is descriptive. An empiricist may therefore accept the whole argument as conceptual geography while denying that it settles ontology. Whether descriptive metaphysics can be more than a very good map of how we think is the standing question about Strawson's programme, and the honest answer is that he never claimed more.

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Persons	"Person" is a primitive concept: it is not compounded from a mind and a body, because both dualism and the no-ownership theory presuppose it.	...The decisive argument is that P-predicates must be ascribable to others on behavioural grounds and to oneself not on those grounds; a concept with that dual condition cannot be constructed from either half.	Strawson defeats Cartesianism more economically than any argument from interaction: he does not ask how mind and body can interact but shows that the question presupposes a prior unity that neither term can supply. The cost is that "primitive" marks the end of analysis rather than an explanation — which is a legitimate result for descriptive metaphysics and an unsatisfying one for anybody who wanted the mind-body problem solved rather than dissolved.
Strawson vs Russell on referring	On Strawson's account, existence is presupposed by the use; when it fails, the attempted assertion lacks an ordinary true/false evaluation.	...This is a claim about ordinary use, not a knock-down refutation of Russellian logical regimentation.	The approaches partly answer different questions. Later presupposition theories also divide between gap, falsity and pragmatic treatments, so Strawson's 1950 proposal must not stand for all of them.

T. QUOTATION, DATING & PROVENANCE DISCIPLINE

Both write in English, so the discipline here is dating, attribution and formula-accuracy — **the commonest failures on this item are misattributed technical proposals.**

Item	Correct provenance	Caution
"Two Dogmas of Empiricism"	<i>The Philosophical Review</i> , January 1951 ; revised in <i>From a Logical Point of View</i> (1953)	 The famous "web of belief" / "field of force" passage is §6, "Empiricism without the Dogmas." Cite the section.
"Any statement can be held true come what may..."	"Two Dogmas," §6	 Safe verbatim.  Do not truncate it — the conditional clause ("if we make drastic enough adjustments elsewhere in the system") is the doctrine.
"To be is to be the value of a bound variable"	Standard slogan for the criterion developed in "On What There Is" (<i>Review of Metaphysics</i> , 1948)	 Treat as a canonical summary rather than assume every printed wording is a verbatim sentence; it is not from "Two Dogmas."
<i>Word and Object</i>	1960	Radical translation, gavagai, stimulus meaning, analytical hypotheses — ch. 2 .  The epigraph is Neurath's boat — cross-cite Logical-Positivism.md §P.

Item	Correct provenance	Caution
"Ontological Relativity"	Dewey Lectures, 1968 ; in <i>Ontological Relativity and Other Essays</i> (1969) — the same volume as " Epistemology Naturalized "	⚠ Do not date naturalised epistemology to 1951.
Quantum logic	✅ Birkhoff and von Neumann, "The Logic of Quantum Mechanics," <i>Annals of Mathematics</i> , 1936 — the formal proposal. ✅ Putnam, "Is Logic Empirical?", 1968 — the claim that logic is empirically revisable.	❌ Never write "Putnam/Birkhoff" as a joint proposal, and never merge the dates. ? Add that Putnam later abandoned the position, and that Quine's own <i>Philosophy of Logic</i> (1970) resists revision of logic via "change of logic, change of subject" and the maxim of minimum mutilation .
Duhem	<i>La Théorie physique: son objet, sa structure</i> (1906); Eng. <i>The Aim and Structure of Physical Theory</i> (tr. Wiener, 1954)	⚠ Duhem restricted the thesis to physics and exempted logic and mathematics. The label " Duhem–Quine thesis " is later shorthand for two non-identical claims — say so.
Popper	<i>Logik der Forschung</i> (1934); Eng. 1959	⚠ Popper accepts the logical point and answers it methodologically; do not present him as denying Duhem–Quine.
<i>Individuals: An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics</i>	1959	Basic particulars Pt I; persons ch. 3; the subtitle contains the phrase "descriptive metaphysics" — quote the subtitle , it is exact.
"On Referring"	<i>Mind</i> , 1950	⚠ Predates <i>Individuals</i> by nine years; it is not an application of descriptive metaphysics but its precursor.
Grice & Strawson, "In Defence of a Dogma"	<i>The Philosophical Review</i> , 1956	⚠ Co-authored with H. P. Grice — attributing it to Strawson alone is a standard slip. Note also the spelling: <i>Defence</i> (British).
<i>The Bounds of Sense</i>	1966	The " non-sequitur of numbing grossness " charge against Kant's Second Analogy is here — see Kant.md §3.6.2. ✅ Safe verbatim; it is Strawson's own phrase.
<i>Introduction to Logical Theory</i>	1952	The dissolution of the problem of induction, ch. 9 .
Chomsky's objection	"Quine's Empirical Assumptions," in <i>Words and Objections</i> (1969)	✅ Attribute the underdetermination objection to Chomsky, not to "critics."
Davidson	"Radical Interpretation " (1973)	⚠ Interpretation , not translation — the change of word marks the change of doctrine (no shared observation-base assumed; charity and a truth-theory instead).

✗ **Never write:** that Quine "rejected empiricism" (he calls his own position empiricism without the dogmas); that Strawson "defended empiricism" (he defends a distinction *against Quine*, which is not the same thing); that Duhem and Quine hold the same thesis; or that Quine denied the existence of meaning *tout court* rather than of meanings as determinate entities.

10. LINK-OUTS

- [Logical Positivism](#) — the empiricism Quine reforms; the analytic/synthetic and reductionist pillars he attacks.
- [Kant](#) — the synthetic a priori that Quine's holism blurs; the transcendental argument form Strawson revives.
- [Moore-Russell-EarlyWittgenstein](#) — Russell's theory of descriptions (which Strawson challenges in "On Referring"); logical analysis tradition both Quine and Strawson inherit.
- [Later Wittgenstein](#) — parallel critique of the picture/verification model of meaning; Strawson's "connective analysis" is closer to Wittgenstein's descriptive method than to Russell's reconstructive one.
- [Empiricism](#) — Hume's empiricism as the ancestor that Quine reforms.
- [A priori / a posteriori](#) — Quine rejects a sharp foundational a priori/a posteriori line.
- [Substance across Western](#) — Strawson's basic particulars as the modern "substance" question.
- [Critiques of Metaphysics](#) — Quine's holism as a solvent; Strawson's descriptive metaphysics as a *revival*.
- [Self and Liberation](#) — Strawson's person concept vs Indian *ātman/anātman* debates.
- Cross-paper: [Notions of God](#) — ontological commitment (Quine) bears on whether "God" is a value of a bound variable.
- PYQ bank: [Western Philosophy PYQs, 2018–2025](#)

SOURCES

- W.V.O. Quine, "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" (1951), reprinted in *From a Logical Point of View*.
- W.V.O. Quine, *Word and Object* (1960) — indeterminacy, ontological relativity.
- P.F. Strawson, *Individuals: An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics* (1959).
- P.F. Strawson, "On Referring" (1950) — the rival to Russell.
- H.P. Grice and P.F. Strawson, "In Defence of a Dogma" (1956) — reply to Quine.
- Y. Masih, *A Critical History of Western Philosophy* (Quine and Strawson chapters).
- Anthony Kenny, *A New History of Western Philosophy*, vol. 4.
- Roger Gibson, *The Philosophy of W.V. Quine* (overview of the system).
- A.C. Grayling (ed.), *Philosophy 2: Further Through the Subject* (Strawson's descriptive metaphysics).

11. COMPLETE FORMAL ASCII MASTER FLOW — 42 PANELS

Formal-session atlas restored as required coverage evidence. Panels 1–42 preserve the authoritative order and panel payload. The corpus panel is the formal 2018–2025 snapshot; the verified 2026 addition remains in section 12 below.

QUINE AND STRAWSON - ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

UPSC PHILOSOPHY OPTIONAL | PAPER I, SECTION A | SYLLABUS ITEM 11

=====

READ TOP TO BOTTOM. 42 PANELS. PURE ASCII. EVERY DATE, SECTION NUMBER,
TECHNICAL TERM AND ATTRIBUTION IS EXAMINABLE AS PRINTED.

=====

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/42: THE PRINTED CLAUSE AND ITS TWO LIMBS

SYLLABUS, VERBATIM

'Quine and Strawson : Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic
Particulars and Persons.'

NOTE: the paper prints a space before the colon. Preserve it ONLY
inside a verbatim quotation of the syllabus.

|

THE TWO LIMBS DIVIDE CLEANLY - ONE OWNER EACH

LIMB 1 CRITIQUE OF EMPIRICISM QUINE 1908-2000
two dogmas, failed explications of analyticity,
reductionism, confirmation holism, revisability, and
empiricism without the dogmas

LIMB 2 THEORY OF BASIC PARTICULARS
AND PERSONS STRAWSON 1919-2006
descriptive metaphysics, identification and
re-identification, the public spatio-temporal framework,
material bodies, and the person as a primitive concept

|

THE ONE MOVE THE CLAUSE MAKES

CLASSICAL AND LOGICAL EMPIRICISM MADE TWO PROMISES:

- (i) every meaningful sentence can be sorted into TRUE BY MEANING
and TRUE BY FACT, and checked against experience ONE AT A TIME
- (ii) the world can be rebuilt out of PRIVATE SENSORY GIVENS

QUINE breaks (i) FROM INSIDE EMPIRICISM.

STRAWSON shows (ii) CANNOT EVEN GET STARTED.

FATAL OPENING: 'The Quine-Strawson critique of empiricism holds that ...'

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/42: THE TWO-PROJECT WARNING - SAY THIS FIRST

THEY ARE NOT ALLIES. THE ONLY DOCUMENTED EXCHANGE IS A DISAGREEMENT.
 GRICE AND STRAWSON, 'IN DEFENCE OF A DOGMA',
 The Philosophical Review, 1956.
 CO-AUTHORED with H. P. GRICE. British spelling: DEFENCE.
 They defend the ANALYTIC/SYNTHETIC DISTINCTION that Quine
 attacked in 1951.

THE TWO PROJECTS, SIDE BY SIDE

+-----+		+-----+	
	QUINE		STRAWSON
	LEVEL the THEORY OF		LEVEL the STARTING POINT
	CONFIRMATION		
	MOVE both dogmas fail;		MOVE identification needs
	sentences face		re-identification,
	experience only as a		which needs ONE public
	CORPORATE BODY		spatio-temporal
			framework
	TOOL logic + naturalism +		TOOL connective conceptual
	behavioural evidence		analysis, TRANSCEN-
			DENTAL IN FORM
	RESULT EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE		RESULT MATERIAL BODIES and
	DOGMAS - he STAYS an		PERSONS are BASIC in
	empiricist		our conceptual scheme
+-----+		+-----+	

THE ONLY LEGITIMATE JOINT SENTENCE

Empiricism failed TWICE OVER: about how theories are CONFIRMED
 (Quine) and about how we so much as REFER (Strawson).
 That is a PROBLEM-FIELD, not a shared thesis.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/42: OWNERSHIP AND THE CORPUS SIGNAL 2018-2025

9 PRIMARY-OWNED QUESTION-PARTS OUT OF 112.

QUINE - FIVE PARTS

2018 Q2(c) 15m a priori as
 'article of
 faith'
 2019 Q1(e) 10m against the
 synthetic-
 analytic
 distinction
 2021 Q3(c) 15m empiricism
 without the
 dogmas
 2024 Q4(c) 15m nature of the

STRAWSON - FOUR PARTS

2018 Q1(e) 10m concept of person
 2020 Q3(b) 15m spatio-temporal
 thinking and basic
 particulars
 2021 Q3(b) 15m material bodies AND
 persons as basic
 particulars
 2023 Q4(a) 20m person as primitive;
 implication for
 mind-body dualism

	two dogmas		THE ONLY 20-MARKER IN THE CLAUSE IS
2025 Q4(b) 15m	'affirm the		STRAWSON'S, IN 2023.
	truth of any		
	sentence ...'		

YEAR DISTRIBUTION

2018 TWO | 2019 one | 2020 one | 2021 TWO | 2022 NONE
 2023 one | 2024 one | 2025 one

CONSEQUENCE: frequent but NOT guaranteed. Prepare it to ANSWER, not to recognise. DECIDE THE OWNER FROM THE STEM BEFORE WRITING A LINE.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/42: THE OWNERSHIP FENCE - WHAT IS NOT OWNED HERE

VERIFICATION PRINCIPLE, AYER, CARNAP'S AUFBAU,
 THE VIENNA CIRCLE as DOCTRINE Topic 07 Logical Positivism
 (here ONLY as the position Quine dismantles)

HUME'S IMPRESSIONS AND IDEAS, THE BUNDLE
 SELF, THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION as DOCTRINE Topic 03 Empiricism

KANT'S SYNTHETIC A PRIORI, THE TRANSCENDENTAL
 DEDUCTION, THE ANTINOMIES as DOCTRINE Topic 04 Kant
 (here ONLY through the 2018 framing and Strawson's affinity)

RUSSELL'S THEORY OF DESCRIPTIONS as DOCTRINE Topic 06 Moore-Russell-
 Early Wittgenstein
 (here ONLY as the rival 'On Referring' answers)

MEANING AS USE, LANGUAGE-GAMES, THE PRIVATE
 LANGUAGE ARGUMENT as DOCTRINE Topic 08 Later Wittgenstein
 (here ONLY as a bounded comparison)

STRAWSON ON FREEDOM, RESENTMENT AND THE
 REACTIVE ATTITUDES ('Freedom and
 Resentment', 1962) BOUNDED / CROSS-OWNED.
 NOT a printed limb. NOT PYQ-OWNED 2018-2025. One clause maximum.

STRAWSON ON INDUCTION (1952) AND ON KANT
 (1966) bounded enrichment only

PERSONAL IDENTITY OVER TIME, THE SOUL,
 IMMORTALITY Paper II

BOUNDED QUINE ENRICHMENT - TAUGHT IN FULL, USED AFTER THE PRINTED BURDEN
 ontological commitment | radical translation and gavagai |
 inscrutability | indeterminacy | ontological relativity |
 naturalized epistemology
 NOT independently printed and NOT PYQ-owned in 2018-2025.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/42: PROVENANCE RAIL, PART ONE - 1905 TO 1953

1905 RUSSELL, 'On Denoting'. The theory of descriptions.
 Topic 06's property; the position 'On Referring' answers.

- 1906 DUHEM, La Theorie physique: son objet, sa structure.
Eng. The Aim and Structure of Physical Theory, tr. Wiener, 1954.
PHYSICS ONLY. LOGIC AND MATHEMATICS EXEMPT.
- 1928 CARNAP, Der logische Aufbau der Welt. The construction of the
world from private experience. Topic 07's property; the
programme Strawson's basic-particulars argument makes unworkable.
- 1934 POPPER, Logik der Forschung. Eng. 1959. ACCEPTS the logical
point of Duhem-Quine and answers it METHODOLOGICALLY.
- 1936 BIRKHOFF AND VON NEUMANN, 'The Logic of Quantum Mechanics',
Annals of Mathematics. The FORMAL proposal: a NON-DISTRIBUTIVE
LATTICE. NOT yet the claim that logic is empirical.
- 1948 QUINE, 'On What There Is', Review of Metaphysics.
THE CRITERION OF ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENT IS DEVELOPED HERE.
'To be is to be the value of a bound variable' is the standard
slogan for it. IT IS NOT FROM 'TWO DOGMAS'.
- 1950 STRAWSON, 'On Referring', Mind. PRESUPPOSITION against
Russell's ASSERTED existence-claim. PREDATES Individuals by
NINE YEARS - a PRECURSOR, not an application of descriptive
metaphysics.
- 1951 QUINE, 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism', The Philosophical Review,
JANUARY 1951. The web-of-belief / field-of-force passage is
SECTION 6, 'Empiricism without the Dogmas'. CITE THE SECTION.
- 1953 From a Logical Point of View - 'Two Dogmas' REVISED and
reprinted. Both dates are correct for different versions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/42: PROVENANCE RAIL, PART TWO - 1956 TO 1985

- 1952 STRAWSON, Introduction to Logical Theory. The dissolution of
the problem of induction, CH. 9. Optional.
- 1956 GRICE AND STRAWSON, 'In Defence of a Dogma',
The Philosophical Review. CO-AUTHORED. Spelling: DEFENCE.
- 1959 STRAWSON, Individuals: An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics.
BASIC PARTICULARS: PART I. PERSONS: CH. 3.
The phrase is in the SUBTITLE - quote the subtitle, it is exact.
- 1960 QUINE, Word and Object. Radical translation, gavagai, stimulus
meaning, analytical hypotheses: CH. 2.
EPIGRAPH: NEURATH'S BOAT.
- 1962 STRAWSON, 'Freedom and Resentment'. NOT a printed limb.
- 1966 STRAWSON, The Bounds of Sense. The 'non-sequitur of numbing
grossness' charge against Kant's Second Analogy. Safe verbatim;
Strawson's own phrase. Belongs mainly to Topic 04.
- 1968 PUTNAM, 'Is Logic Empirical?' THE CLAIM that the DISTRIBUTIVE
LAW should be revised on EMPIRICAL grounds. Reprinted 1976.
PUTNAM LATER ABANDONED THE POSITION.
- 1968 QUINE, Dewey Lectures, 'Ontological Relativity'.
- 1969 Published in Ontological Relativity and Other Essays - the SAME

- volume as 'EPISTEMOLOGY NATURALIZED'.
DO NOT DATE NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY TO 1951.
- 1969 CHOMSKY, 'Quine's Empirical Assumptions', in Words and Objections. ATTRIBUTE the underdetermination objection to CHOMSKY, not to 'critics'.
- 1970 QUINE, Philosophy of Logic. 'CHANGE OF LOGIC, CHANGE OF SUBJECT' and the MAXIM OF MINIMUM MUTILATION.
- 1973 DAVIDSON, 'Radical INTERPRETATION'. Interpretation, NOT translation - the change of word marks the change of doctrine.
- 1985 STRAWSON, Skepticism and Naturalism. Transcendental arguments limited to internal, descriptive work. Optional.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/42: DOGMA ONE - THE CLAIM UNDER TEST

THE DOGMA

There is a PRINCIPLED, NON-ARBITRARY line between
ANALYTIC = true by virtue of MEANING alone
SYNTHETIC = true by virtue of extra-linguistic FACT
WHY QUINE CALLS IT A DOGMA: the line cannot be drawn NON-CIRCULARLY.

|

THE TWO CLASSES OF ANALYTIC TRUTH - START HERE, NOT AT 'CIRCULARITY'

CLASS 1 LOGICALLY TRUE

'No unmarried man is married.'
True under EVERY reinterpretation of the non-logical words.
Quine GRANTS this class; it is not where the trouble lies.

CLASS 2 TRUE BY SUBSTITUTING SYNONYMS FOR SYNONYMS

'No bachelor is married.' Put 'unmarried man' for
'bachelor' and it BECOMES a Class 1 truth.
THIS class is the one that needs SYNONYMY.

|

THE QUESTION THAT DRIVES THE WHOLE PAPER

WHAT IS SYNONYMY? Three routes are available. Each returns to the platform it left. PANELS 8, 9 AND 10 TAKE THEM IN ORDER.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/42: DOGMA ONE, ROUTE ONE - DEFINITION

THE PROPOSAL

'Two terms are synonymous when one is DEFINED as the other.
The lexicographer defines bachelor as unmarried man.'

|

THE FAILURE

EXCEPT for FRANKLY STIPULATIVE definitions, a definition REPORTS a synonymy that ALREADY OBTAINED in the language. The lexicographer is an empirical scientist recording usage.

|

WHY THIS IS CIRCULAR - STATE IT PRECISELY

The circularity is in the EXPLANATORY ORDER, not in the sentence. Definitions are not circular IN FORM. The objection is that a definition PRESUPPOSES the relation it was called in to explain.

|

WHAT QUINE CONCEDES

Stipulative definition DOES create synonymy - by fiat, in a new notation. It cannot ground the general notion for a language already in use.

TRAP: writing 'definitions are circular' misstates the objection.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/42: DOGMA ONE, ROUTE TWO - SALVA VERITATE

THE PROPOSAL

'Two terms are synonymous when they are INTERCHANGEABLE SALVA VERITATE - swapping them never changes a truth-value.'

|

FAILURE (a) - OVER-GENERATION IN AN EXTENSIONAL LANGUAGE

'CREATURE WITH A HEART' and 'CREATURE WITH A KIDNEY' are COEXTENSIVE, so they interchange freely - YET THEY ARE NOT SYNONYMOUS. The test admits pairs it should exclude.

|

THE PROPOSED REPAIR

'Then demand interchange inside NECESSARILY (...).'

|

FAILURE (b) - THE REPAIR PRESUPPOSES THE TARGET

The language must already contain a NECESSITY operator whose intelligibility, for Quine, rests on ANALYTICITY. So the repair presupposes exactly what was to be explained.

|

SHAPE OF THE ARGUMENT

WEAK TEST -> lets in too much. STRONG TEST -> assumes the answer. There is no setting of the dial that works.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/42: DOGMA ONE, ROUTE THREE - SEMANTICAL RULES

THE PROPOSAL (CARNAP)

'Analyticity is DEFINED for an artificial language L by explicit SEMANTICAL RULES. A sentence is analytic-in-L if the rules say so.'

|

WHAT IT DELIVERS

A LIST. We learn which sentences are analytic-IN-L.

|

WHAT IT DOES NOT DELIVER

The GENERAL explanatory notion. 'Semantical rule' is no clearer

than 'analytic'. We learn the MEMBERSHIP of a set; we do not learn what MEMBERSHIP CONSISTS IN.

|

THE STRUCTURAL POINT

Relativising to L moves the problem, it does not solve it. The question 'what makes THESE the semantical rules?' is the original question in new clothing.

TRAP: treating 'analytic-in-L' as a successful definition of 'analytic' concedes the very generality Quine denies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/42: DOGMA ONE - THE EXACT CONCLUSION

WHAT QUINE CONCLUDES

The AVAILABLE EXPLICATIONS FAIL to provide the clear, NON-QUESTION-BEGGING boundary that logical empiricism required.

|

WHAT QUINE DOES NOT CONCLUDE

NOT 'All bachelors are unmarried' is FALSE.
NOT the word 'analytic' has NO USE in any language.
NOT from ONE missing dictionary definition that EVERY use of 'analytic' is unintelligible.

|

WHAT REPLACES THE DISTINCTION

HOLISTIC REVISABILITY replaces categorical immunity with DEGREES OF PRACTICAL ENTRENCHMENT. Central statements are revised rarely; peripheral ones easily.

|

CENTRALITY CAUTION - THE MOST MISSED CONTROL ON THIS SUB-TOPIC

Practical entrenchment EXPLAINS why logic and mathematics are normally protected. IT IS NOT A REPLACEMENT DEFINITION OF 'ANALYTIC'. Presenting it as one converts a strength into an error.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/42: DOGMA ONE - THE OBJECTION AND THE REJOINDER

GRICE AND STRAWSON, 'IN DEFENCE OF A DOGMA', 1956

- 1 The distinction is ORDINARILY INTELLIGIBLE: competent speakers agree on cases WITHOUT theory.
- 2 A distinction in good working order is not discredited merely because no REDUCTIVE ANALYSIS of it is available.
- 3 Quine sets the bar TOO HIGH - he demands a non-circular DEFINITION where what we have is a usable DISTINCTION.

|

QUINE'S REJOINDER

ORDINARY INTELLIGIBILITY IS NOT THEORETICAL LEGITIMACY.
Agreement in classification does not supply the principled ground

on which the POSITIVIST MEANING-CRITERION and the LINGUISTIC THEORY OF NECESSITY were resting.

Compare: speakers once agreed in applying 'witch' / 'non-witch'.

|

THE STANDING DISPUTE - NAME IT, THEN TAKE A GRADED SIDE

The quarrel is about STANDARDS OF EXPLICATION.

DEFENSIBLE VERDICT: Quine strongly pressures the distinction's FOUNDATIONAL use while leaving room for more modest semantic or ordinary classifications.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 13/42: DOGMA TWO - REDUCTIONISM IN TWO FORMS

THE DOGMA

Each meaningful statement has its OWN private stock of confirming or disconfirming experiences, so statements can be checked ONE AT A TIME.

|

RADICAL FORM

Every meaningful statement is TRANSLATABLE into a language of immediate experience, TERM BY TERM.

Historical exemplar: CARNAP'S AUFBAU, 1928.

|

ATTENUATED FORM

Give up translation. RETAIN the claim that each statement, taken alone, has its own range of confirming and disconfirming experiences.

|

WHY THE LABEL 'REDUCTIONISM' FITS - A CHEAP MARK MOST SCRIPTS MISS

The doctrine REDUCES the meaning of each sentence to a SET OF OBSERVATION SENTENCES. The name states the operation.

|

ONE OBJECTION DEFEATS BOTH FORMS

Both assume a SENTENCE-SIZED PARCEL OF EVIDENCE. Remove that and both collapse together.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 14/42: DOGMA TWO - THE CORPORATE BODY

THE CANONICAL SENTENCE - QUOTE IT EXACTLY

'Our statements about the external world face the tribunal of sense experience NOT INDIVIDUALLY BUT ONLY AS A CORPORATE BODY.'

|

THE UNIT OF EMPIRICAL SIGNIFICANCE

NOT the TERM that programme had already collapsed
NOT the SENTENCE that is the dogma being removed
BUT THE WHOLE OF SCIENCE

|

WHAT IS AND IS NOT DENIED

 DENIED that experience bears on beliefs ONE AT A TIME

 RETAINED that experience bears on belief AT ALL

 THIS IS WHY THE RESULTING POSITION IS STILL CALLED EMPIRICISM.

TRAP: 'Quine denies that experience tests belief.' The tribunal still sits. It hears the SYSTEM.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/42: THE TWO DOGMAS ARE AT ROOT IDENTICAL

QUINE'S OWN ARCHITECTURAL JUDGEMENT

The two dogmas are AT ROOT IDENTICAL.

|

THE ARGUMENT

DOGMA 1 survives only if SOME statements are confirmed
INDEPENDENTLY OF EXPERIENCE - 'confirmed come what may'.

|

That contrast needs a CONTRAST CLASS: statements confirmed
INDIVIDUALLY by their own experiences.

|

DOGMA 2 supplies exactly that picture.

|

REMOVE DOGMA 2 -> DOGMA 1 HAS NOTHING TO BE A CONTRAST TO.

|

WHY THIS EARNS MARKS

It converts a LIST of two criticisms into an ARGUMENT with a
structure. It is the closing line of any 2024 Q4(c) answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 16/42: THE WEB OF BELIEF - THE STRUCTURE

SOURCE: 'Two Dogmas', SECTION 6, 'Empiricism without the Dogmas'.

THE MODEL: a WEB, or a FIELD OF FORCE, whose BOUNDARY CONDITIONS are
EXPERIENCE.

(o)	(o)	(o)	(o)	(o)	PERIPHERY: OBSERVATION
\	\		/	/	SENTENCES, in direct contact
\	\		/	/	with experience
[physics, chemistry, biology]					revised comparatively easily
[mathematics]					revised rarely
[LOGIC]					revised last; NEVER immune

WHAT THE PICTURE ASSERTS

Only the EDGE touches experience. The interior is connected to it
by inferential threads. A collision at the edge produces
RE-ADJUSTMENT INSIDE; the interior is not directly hit.

CAUTION: the periphery is OBSERVATION SENTENCES, NOT private SENSE-DATA. Quine is REJECTING the sense-datum programme here, not restating it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 17/42: THE WEB - THE THREE REVISION OPTIONS

A CONFLICT ARRIVES AT THE EDGE. SOMETHING MUST GIVE. THREE THINGS MAY BE DONE, AND EXPERIENCE DOES NOT CHOOSE BETWEEN THEM.

- |
- OPTION 1 REVISE A NEARBY PERIPHERAL BELIEF easiest
 - OPTION 2 REVISE A DEEP INTERIOR STATEMENT costly but
open in
principle
 - OPTION 3 PLEAD HALLUCINATION - revise the OBSERVATION
STATEMENT ITSELF always
available

|

WHY OPTION 3 MATTERS

It is what makes 'ANY statement can be held true come what may' LITERALLY TRUE rather than rhetorical. Omit it and the famous sentence looks like an exaggeration.

|

WHAT THE THREE OPTIONS ESTABLISH

Experience says 'SOMETHING HERE IS WRONG'.
Experience NEVER says 'THAT SENTENCE IS WRONG'.
The gap between those two sentences is the whole doctrine.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 18/42: THE TWO CANONICAL SENTENCES

SENTENCE ONE - THE 2025 Q4(b) QUOTATION

'ANY STATEMENT CAN BE HELD TRUE COME WHAT MAY, IF WE MAKE DRASTIC ENOUGH ADJUSTMENTS ELSEWHERE IN THE SYSTEM.'

THE CONDITIONAL CLAUSE IS THE DOCTRINE.

It names the COST, and the cost is what DISCIPLINES the choice. TRUNCATING IT AT 'COME WHAT MAY' PRODUCES RELATIVISM, WHICH IS NOT THE DOCTRINE. This is the commonest way to fail 2025 Q4(b).

|

SENTENCE TWO - THE CONVERSE

'CONVERSELY, BY THE SAME TOKEN, NO STATEMENT IS IMMUNE TO REVISION.'

The EARLY essay extends this IN PRINCIPLE even to a LAW OF LOGIC, mentioning the proposed revision of the law of EXCLUDED MIDDLE as a means of simplifying quantum mechanics.

IT DOES NOT FOLLOW that every revision is equally rational, or that logic is casually abandoned.

|
THE 2025 PAPER'S WORDING, FOR REFERENCE

'We can affirm the truth of any sentence in our total system, in the face of whatever experience, just so long as we are prepared to make adjustments elsewhere.'

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 19/42: THE FOUR CONSEQUENCES OF HOLISM

1 NO SHARP ANALYTIC/SYNTHETIC LINE

Central logic and mathematics are highly entrenched and normally protected, but CENTRALITY MUST NOT BE EQUATED with a new definition of analyticity.

2 NO SHARP A PRIORI / A POSTERIORI LINE

All beliefs are revisable in the light of experience, even those remote from the periphery.

3 PRAGMATISM ABOUT THEORY-CHOICE

When revision is needed we choose on grounds of SIMPLICITY, CONSERVATISM and FECUNDITY - pragmatic virtues, NOT algorithmic rules.

4 PRESSURE ON POSITIVIST MEANING-CRITERIA

SENTENCE-BY-SENTENCE reductionist verification is undermined.
WHETHER A HOLISTIC VERIFICATIONISM SURVIVES IS A FURTHER QUESTION - the paper does not settle it.

|
STATE CONSEQUENCE 4 CAREFULLY. Saying 'holism refutes verificationism' overstates the result and invites correction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 20/42: WHAT BLOCKS ARBITRARY REVISION

THE OBJECTION

'If EVERYTHING is revisable, science has no fixed point at all, and rational belief has no constraint. Is holism even coherent?'

|
THE CONSTRAINTS - NAME THEM, OR THE OBJECTION STANDS

PREDICTIVE SUCCESS revisions must keep the system predicting
CONSERVATISM change as little as possible
SIMPLICITY prefer the economical system
FECUNDITY prefer the system that generates results
MINIMUM MUTILATION Philosophy of Logic, 1970

|
THE EXACT FORMULA

NO STATEMENT IS REVISABLE BY NATURE, ONLY BY CHOICE - and choice has COSTS.

|
WHAT HOLISM DOES AND DOES NOT LICENSE

LICENSES	the RE-ALLOCATION OF BLAME across the system
DOES NOT	indifference to evidence, or the claim that all
LICENSE	revisions are equally warranted

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 21/42: THE DUHEM-QUINE ARGUMENT, NUMBERED

- 1 The testable claim is (H & A) -> 0
 H = the hypothesis under test
 A = the auxiliaries: background theory, INSTRUMENT THEORY,
 initial conditions
- 2 Observation reports NOT-0
- 3 By MODUS TOLLENS all that follows is NOT (H & A)
 i.e. H is false OR some element of A is false
- 4 LOGIC DOES NOT SAY WHICH CONJUNCT TO REJECT. Evidence,
 background knowledge and methodological virtues can still make
 some revisions far more reasonable than others.
- 5 THEREFORE refutation is never conclusive against a SINGLE
 statement - and, symmetrically, 'any statement can be held true
 come what may, if we make drastic enough adjustments elsewhere in
 the system'.
- 6 THEREFORE a reductionist criterion assigning each statement its
 own confirming experiences HAS NO APPLICATION. This attacks
 DOGMA 2 directly; it PRESSURES, but does not by itself refute,
 every possible holistic verificationism.

|

PRESUPPOSITIONS - WHERE EVERY OBJECTION ENTERS

- P1 hypotheses generate predictions ONLY with auxiliaries
- P2 no fixed decomposition uniquely assigns every recalcitrant
 experience to ONE sentence
- P3 theory-choice employs PRAGMATIC VIRTUES alongside evidence

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 22/42: DUHEM AGAINST QUINE - TWO NON-IDENTICAL CLAIMS

	DUHEM (1906)		QUINE (1951)
SCOPE	PHYSICS ONLY. Physiology and certain other sciences CAN test hypotheses more nearly in isolation.		ALL OF KNOWLEDGE. 'The unit of empirical significance is THE WHOLE OF SCIENCE.'
LOGIC AND MATHEMATICS	EXEMPT. Duhem does not put them at risk.		INCLUDED. 'No statement is immune to revision', not even a law of logic.
CHIEF COROLLARY	There is no automatic EXPERIMENTUM CRUCIS against an		Confirmation holism and underdetermination

isolated hypothesis, since
auxiliaries are also in play.

| pressure. The stronger
| claim of rival total
| theories equivalent
| under ALL possible
| evidence needs FURTHER
| argument.

-----+-----
MOTIVE

Philosophy of physics; the
practice of physicists.

| The demolition of the
| SECOND DOGMA,
| reductionism.

=====

THE LABEL 'DUHEM-QUINE THESIS' IS LATER SHORTHAND FOR TWO
NON-IDENTICAL CLAIMS. SAYING SO IS ITSELF A MARK.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 23/42: NEPTUNE AND VULCAN - DEPLOY BOTH

CASE ONE - URANUS

Orbit conflicts with Newtonian prediction.

- > astronomers DO NOT abandon Newton's laws
- > they revise the AUXILIARY 'we know all the planets'
- > NEPTUNE IS FOUND. Le Verrier and Adams, 1846.
- > THE SHALLOW REVISION WAS CORRECT.

|

CASE TWO - MERCURY

Perihelion conflicts with Newtonian prediction.

- > the SAME strategy posits the planet 'VULCAN'
- > VULCAN DOES NOT EXIST
- > the correct revision was the DEEP one: GENERAL RELATIVITY,
1915.
- > THE DEEP REVISION WAS CORRECT.

|

WHAT THE PAIR PROVES

SAME LOGICAL SITUATION. OPPOSITE CORRECT RESPONSES.

NO RULE SAYS IN ADVANCE WHICH TO CHOOSE.

That is the thesis, HISTORICALLY DEMONSTRATED.

TRAP: citing NEPTUNE ALONE makes holism look like a recipe for saving
theories. The PAIR shows it is a claim about the ABSENCE of a recipe.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 24/42: POPPER AND LAKATOS - THE REPLY THAT CONCEDES

POPPER - Logik der Forschung 1934; Eng. 1959

ACCEPTS THE LOGICAL POINT ENTIRELY and denies its SCEPTICAL USE.

Falsification is not an automatic logical process but a
METHODOLOGICAL DECISION.

Scientists agree BY CONVENTION to treat certain BASIC STATEMENTS

as unproblematic for the purposes of a test.
They FORBID AD HOC RESCUES that reduce a theory's TESTABILITY.
RATIONALITY IS PRESERVED BY RULES OF METHOD, NOT BY LOGIC ALONE.

|

LAKATOS

Develops this into RESEARCH PROGRAMMES with
a protected HARD CORE - not surrendered
a revisable PROTECTIVE BELT - where revision is taken
Duhem-Quine turned into a CRITERION OF PROGRESS.

|

TRAP TO AVOID

'Popper refutes Duhem-Quine.' HE DOES NOT. He grants the logic
and answers it with method. Misreporting this is a factual error
an examiner can check.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 25/42: THE REVISABILITY OF LOGIC - 1936 / 1968 / 1970

THE EARLY CLAIM (1951)

'No statement is immune to revision', applied even to the law of
EXCLUDED MIDDLE.

|

THE STRONGEST CANDIDATE - TWO ACTS, THIRTY-TWO YEARS APART

1936 BIRKHOFF AND VON NEUMANN, 'The Logic of Quantum Mechanics',
Annals of Mathematics. A NON-DISTRIBUTIVE LATTICE of
propositions. THIS IS A MATHEMATICAL PROPOSAL.

1968 PUTNAM, 'Is Logic Empirical?' THE CLAIM that LOGIC IS
EMPIRICAL - that the DISTRIBUTIVE LAW should be revised on
EMPIRICAL grounds. Reprinted 1976.

THIS IS A PHILOSOPHICAL CLAIM ABOUT THE FIRST.

NEVER WRITE 'PUTNAM/BIRKHOFF'. NEVER MERGE THE DATES.

PUTNAM LATER ABANDONED THE POSITION.

|

THE RESISTANCE - FROM QUINE HIMSELF

1970 Philosophy of Logic. 'CHANGE OF LOGIC, CHANGE OF SUBJECT':
anyone who 'denies' a law of logic has merely changed the
meaning of the connectives, so no genuine disagreement has
occurred. Plus the MAXIM OF MINIMUM MUTILATION.

|

THE HONEST VERDICT

HOLISM IS RIGHT ABOUT CONFIRMATION AND OVERSTATED ABOUT
REVISABILITY. The defensible position is DUHEM'S THESIS WITH
QUINE'S MOTIVATION. The LATER Quine is a poor witness for the
EARLIER Quine's most radical claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 26/42: EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS

WHAT IS THROWN AWAY		WHAT IS KEPT
the analytic/synthetic		SENSORY EVIDENCE as the check on
boundary as a FOUNDATION		the system
confirmation of sentences		NATURALISM: philosophy is
ONE AT A TIME		continuous with science
a privileged class of truths		the demand that ontology be
IMMUNE to experience		answerable to the best theory

WHAT CHANGES

The boundary between SPECULATIVE METAPHYSICS and NATURAL SCIENCE becomes a matter of DEGREE.

Ontological questions are decided, like scientific ones, by the PRAGMATIC VIRTUES of the total system.

There is NO FIRST PHILOSOPHY standing outside science to certify its foundations.

THE LABEL, AND WHY IT MATTERS

The section title is 'EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS'. The word 'without' does all the work: SUBTRACTION, NOT REPLACEMENT.

CALLING THIS AN INTERNAL REFORM IS SAFER THAN CALLING QUINE EITHER A LOGICAL POSITIVIST OR THE UNIQUELY PURIFIED EMPIRICIST.

NEVER WRITE: 'Quine rejected empiricism.'

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 27/42: THE 2018 FRAMING AND THE THREE MOVES

THE PHRASE

'A METAPHYSICAL ARTICLE OF FAITH' is the 2018 QUESTION'S FRAMING.

IT IS NOT A VERIFIED VERBATIM QUINE QUOTATION.

DO NOT PLACE IT IN QUOTATION MARKS AS QUINE'S OWN FORMULA.

WHAT QUINE DOES SUPPLY - THREE CONNECTED MOVES

MOVE 1 THE EXPLICATION FAILS. Kant's synthetic a priori presupposes a workable analytic/synthetic boundary; the circle of synonymy shows none is available.

MOVE 2 HOLISM. Statements face experience as a corporate body, so NO BELIEF IS A PRIORI BY NATURE. Apparent apriority is greater CENTRALITY in the web - a difference of DEGREE.

MOVE 3 NATURALISM. There is no first-philosophy standpoint from which a priori knowledge could be certified. To assert it is to take on trust what cannot be shown.

THE KANTIAN REPLY, AND THE REJOINDER

REPLY transcendental conditions of experience are not empirical hypotheses inside the web, so revisability does not reach them. Strawson's descriptive reading of Kant

gives this some support.

REJOINER that reasserts precisely the privileged non-empirical status in question.

VERDICT: Quine defeats a SHARP a priori/a posteriori boundary; a gradient of entrenchment survives; the framework question stays open.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 28/42: ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENT - BOUNDED ENRICHMENT

SOURCE: 'ON WHAT THERE IS', Review of Metaphysics, 1948.

NOT 'TWO DOGMAS'.

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THE CRITERION, STEP BY STEP

- 1 REGIMENT the accepted theory into perspicuous QUANTIFICATIONAL FORM.
- 2 READ OFF the entities that must lie in the RANGES OF THE BOUND VARIABLES for the theory to be TRUE.
- 3 THOSE are the theory's ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENTS.
- 4 'TO BE IS TO BE THE VALUE OF A BOUND VARIABLE' is the standard SLOGAN. Treat it as a canonical summary, not as a guaranteed verbatim sentence.

|

FOUR CAUTIONS - EACH IS A MARK

- 1 A criterion of COMMITMENT, not a rule for CHOOSING an ontology.
- 2 NOT surface word-counting: names can be PARAPHRASED AWAY, and apparently name-free quantification can carry commitment.
- 3 'TASTE FOR DESERT LANDSCAPES' = PARSIMONY, not nominalism at any cost. Quine accepts abstract entities where the best regimented science INDISPENSABLY quantifies over them.
- 4 The INDISPENSABILITY ARGUMENT is associated with QUINE AND PUTNAM together, not with the slogan alone.

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THE OBJECTION, CONCEDED BY DESIGN

Rival PARAPHRASES display different commitments -> the criterion is applied AFTER theory and regimentation are chosen. It AUDITS; it does not CHOOSE.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 29/42: RADICAL TRANSLATION - THE EVIDENCE AND THE TERMS

SOURCE: WORD AND OBJECT, 1960, CH. 2. Epigraph: NEURATH'S BOAT.

THE SITUATION: a field linguist enters a community whose language has no known relation to any other. NO dictionary. NO bilingual informant. NO shared script. The only evidence is WHAT SPEAKERS ARE EXPOSED TO and WHAT THEY ASSENT TO OR DISSENT FROM.

|

THE EXACT PRINTED SUBTERMS - EACH IS A DISTINCT DEVICE

STIMULUS MEANING	the class of stimulations that would prompt ASSENT to a sentence, paired with the class that would prompt DISSENT
OCCASION SENTENCE	assent commanded only when FRESHLY PROMPTED ('Gavagai', 'It's raining')
STANDING SENTENCE	assent PERSISTS without prompting ('Copper conducts electricity')
OBSERVATION SENTENCE	an occasion sentence whose stimulus meaning is CONSTANT ACROSS SPEAKERS of the community - THE ONLY PLACE TRANSLATION IS SECURE
ANALYTICAL HYPOTHESES	the linguist's posited segmentation of native sentences into words and grammatical apparatus, projected BEYOND the observational base. THESE ARE NOT DETERMINED BY ANY EVIDENCE.

|

STATUS: BOUNDED ENRICHMENT. Taught in full; used only AFTER the two-dogmas and holism burden is discharged.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 30/42: GAVAGAI - THE NINE-STEP ARGUMENT

-
- 1 A rabbit runs past; the native utters 'GAVAGAI'. The linguist notes assent under rabbit-stimulation and records 'RABBIT'.
 - 2 The SAME stimulus meaning is equally compatible with
'UNDETACHED RABBIT-PARTS' - wherever a rabbit is, they are
'A TEMPORAL STAGE OF A RABBIT' - likewise co-extensive
'RABBITHOOD' - an instantiation of the universal
'IT'S RABBITING' - a feature-placing sentence with NO OBJECT
 - 3 Could he simply ASK, 'is this gavagai the same as that one?'
NO. That question requires him to have ALREADY TRANSLATED the
IDENTITY PREDICATE, the articles, plurals and quantifiers - the
entire APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION, which differs across languages
and is EXACTLY WHAT IS IN DISPUTE.
 - 4 Any evidence he collects can be ACCOMMODATED by COMPENSATING
ADJUSTMENTS: a different translation of 'gavagai' offset by a
different translation of 'same'. The two manuals predict
IDENTICAL behaviour throughout.
 - 5 THEREFORE INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE: behavioural evidence does
not uniquely determine whether a term refers to rabbits,
undetached rabbit parts or rabbit stages.
 - 6 Extending upward from TERMS to SENTENCES, rival ANALYTICAL
HYPOTHESES generate manuals that agree on ALL observation
sentences yet translate theoretical and non-observational
sentences into NON-EQUIVALENT English.
 - 7 THEREFORE INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION: incompatible manuals can
fit the total behavioural evidence without a further

meaning-fact selecting one.

- 8 THEREFORE there are no determinate MEANINGS as entities; SYNONYMY has no behavioural anchor; and DOGMA ONE'S KEY NOTION IS LEFT WITHOUT FOUNDATION. Gavagai is the CONSTRUCTIVE COMPLETION of 'Two Dogmas'.
- 9 ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY is the broader thesis that reference is specified RELATIVE TO A BACKGROUND THEORY. Keep it distinct from the 1948 criterion of commitment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 31/42: TAXONOMY CONTROL - FOUR DOCTRINES, FOUR UNITS

DOCTRINE	UNIT AT ISSUE	CLAIM
RADICAL TRANSLATION	method/situation	translation built from publicly available evidence with no prior dictionary
INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION	sentences / MANUALS	incompatible manuals can preserve the TOTAL evidence
INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE	SUB-SENTENTIAL TERMS	reference can vary under compensating changes in the individuation apparatus
ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY	FRAMEWORKS	reference is fixed only RELATIVE TO a background theory

KEEP THE 1948 CRITERION OUT OF THIS TABLE. It asks what a REGIMENTED THEORY QUANTIFIES OVER. Relativity asks RELATIVE TO WHAT reference itself is fixed. Two questions, two dates, two jobs.
TRAP: using 'indeterminacy' and 'inscrutability' interchangeably.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 32/42: OBJECTIONS TO INDETERMINACY, AND THE PREMISES

THE PREMISES - STATE THEM; EVERY OBJECTION ENTERS HERE

- P1 BEHAVIOURISM ABOUT THE EVIDENCE. Quine's own formulation: in psychology one may or may not be a behaviourist, but IN LINGUISTICS ONE HAS NO CHOICE, since language is learned wholly from publicly observable behaviour.
- P2 THE EVIDENTIAL STEP. The move from total behavioural equivalence to 'NO FURTHER FACT' is a SUBSTANTIVE QUINEAN

COMMITMENT, not a neutral consequence every holist accepts.

P3 NATURALISM. There is no first-philosophy standpoint from which to certify meanings; physics fixes what facts there are.

|

OBJECTION -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL

CHOMSKY 1969 indeterminacy is merely ORDINARY UNDERDETERMINATION; if that does not make physics factless, why translation?

REPLY: in physics there IS a fact our theories imperfectly track; in translation there is NOTHING BEYOND DISPOSITIONS to verbal behaviour for a manual to be right about.

RESIDUAL: whether the ASYMMETRY can be defended without begging the question is THE central dispute. NAME IT AND TAKE A SIDE.

SEARLE; EVANS applied reflexively it entails that I DO NOT DETERMINATELY KNOW WHAT I MEAN by my own words.

REPLY: Quine accepts a version - at home we ACQUIESCE IN OUR MOTHER TONGUE; the first-person case has no privileged status, only a DEFAULT one. RESIDUAL: many find the bullet too large.

CHOMSKY, INNATENESS universal grammar would cut down the space of admissible manuals.

REPLY: the residual manuals would still be behaviourally equivalent; innateness RESTRICTS CANDIDATES, it does not CREATE A FACT OF THE MATTER. RESIDUAL: genuinely open.

DAVIDSON 1973 radical INTERPRETATION shows more determinacy once CHARITY and a TRUTH-THEORY are built in.

REPLY/POSITION: Davidson ACCEPTS indeterminacy but confines it to something like a choice of MEASUREMENT SCALE - Fahrenheit against Celsius - real but harmless. THE MOST INFLUENTIAL SOFTENING.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 33/42: ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY AND NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY

DATES FIRST: DEWEY LECTURES 1968; VOLUME 1969, WHICH ALSO CONTAINS 'EPISTEMOLOGY NATURALIZED'. NEVER DATE EITHER TO 1951.

|

ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY

THESIS what a term refers to is settled only RELATIVE TO a background theory or translation manual.

ROUTE inscrutability generalised: to specify the reference of a term you must use ANOTHER language, whose reference is fixed only relative to a further background - a REGRESS.

STOPPING in practice we ACQUIESCE IN OUR MOTHER TONGUE and take its POINT reference at face value. A DEFAULT, not a privilege.

|

NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY

THESIS epistemology becomes a chapter of empirical psychology: the scientific study of how MEAGRE SENSORY INPUT yields

TORRENTIAL THEORETICAL OUTPUT.

MOTIVE the collapse of the Cartesian and Carnapian foundational projects. If the world cannot be RATIONALLY RECONSTRUCTED from experience, the remaining question is HOW THE CONSTRUCTION IS IN FACT ACHIEVED.

IMAGE NEURATH'S BOAT - we are sailors who must rebuild the ship ON THE OPEN SEA; there is NO DRY DOCK.
The epigraph of Word and Object, 1960.

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THE NORMATIVITY OBJECTION

A causal story about how belief is ACQUIRED appears to replace 'What OUGHT one to believe?' with 'How is belief PRODUCED?'

QUINE'S REPLY

Prediction, truth-seeking and method-selection can be studied and improved FROM WITHIN science - a naturalized normative ENGINEERING of inquiry.

THE RESIDUAL - CONCEDE IT

Continuity with science BLOCKS FIRST PHILOSOPHY but does not by itself DERIVE epistemic norms from causal facts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 34/42: THE QUINE CRITICISM LEDGER - WRITE THE THIRD COLUMN

OBJECTION	REPLY	RESIDUAL
GRICE AND STRAWSON 1956: pre-theoretically clear; we CAN sort cases	the PHILOSOPHICAL WORK done by the distinction collapses without a principled ground	a live debate about STANDARDS OF EXPLICATION
ANALYTICITY SEEMS REAL: 'bachelors are unmarried' differs in KIND from 'all swans are white'	he challenges its foundational EXPLICATION	web-centrality is not a full semantic REPLACEMENT theory
REVISING LOGIC IS EXTREME: has anyone ever done it?	quantum logic: 1936 formal proposal; 1968 empirical claim	the LATER Quine (1970) is a poor witness for the EARLIER Quine
HOLISM IS TOO EXTREME: if EVERYTHING is revisable, science has no fixed point	logic and mathematics revisable IN PRINCIPLE, held fixed in practice by conservatism	no statement is revisable BY NATURE, only by CHOICE

NATURALIZATION LOSES NORMATIVITY	method-selection and prediction ENGINEERED from within science	are truth-conducive norms EXPLAINED or merely ASSUMED?
-----+-----+-----		
COMMITMENT DEPENDS ON REGIMENTATION	correct - applied AFTER theory and regimentation chosen	the criterion AUDITS; it does not CHOOSE
-----+-----+-----		
INDETERMINACY COLLAPSES INTO ORDINARY UNDERDETERMINATION (CHOMSKY)	translation differs: nothing beyond behavioural dispositions	the asymmetry PRESUPPOSES the naturalism it is meant to support

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 35/42: QUINE AND LATER WITTGENSTEIN - BOUNDED COMPARISON

TWO TRADITIONS, NO DIRECT INFLUENCE, A STRIKING CONVERGENCE.		
AXIS	QUINE	LATER WITTGENSTEIN
-----+-----+-----		
TARGET	the MUSEUM MYTH of meaning - words as labels on determinate mental objects	the AUGUSTINIAN PICTURE - words as names of objects
-----+-----+-----		
POSITIVE ACCOUNT	STIMULUS MEANING for suitable occasion sentences; theoretical language is HOLISTIC	meaning is USE within a language-game and a form of life
-----+-----+-----		
HOLISM	the unit is THE WHOLE OF SCIENCE	a word has meaning only within the PRACTICE
-----+-----+-----		
ANTI-FOUNDATION- ALISM	NEURATH'S BOAT - rebuild at sea, no dry dock	bedrock where 'MY SPADE IS TURNED' (PI 217)
-----+-----+-----		
REJECTION OF THE PRIVATE	indeterminacy permits nothing beyond public behaviour to fix meaning	the private-language argument shows nothing private CAN fix meaning
-----+-----+-----		
METHOD	epistemology NATURALISED	philosophy as THERAPY - description, not theory
-----+-----+-----		
WHERE THEY PART - DECISIVELY	Quine REFORMS language - a SCIENTIFIC account and REGIMENTATION into	Wittgenstein DESCRIBES it and forbids theory: ordinary language 'IS IN

=====

USE CAUTIOUSLY. The overlap pressures PRIVATE or MENTALISTIC fixers of meaning. IT DOES NOT ESTABLISH ONE SHARED POSITIVE THEORY. Wittgenstein's own doctrines belong to TOPIC 08.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 36/42: STRAWSON - DESCRIPTIVE AGAINST REVISIONARY METAPHYSICS

DESCRIPTIVE	REVISIONARY
describes the ACTUAL structure of our thought about the world	proposes a BETTER structure to replace the actual one
METHOD: CONNECTIVE ANALYSIS - show how concepts hang together; no concept analysed away into a privileged base	METHOD: RECONSTRUCTION from a preferred set of simples
STRAWSON'S OWN EXAMPLES: ARISTOTLE, KANT	STRAWSON'S OWN EXAMPLES: DESCARTES, LEIBNIZ, BERKELEY

THE RELATION - NOT MERE OPPOSITION

REVISIONARY METAPHYSICS IS IN THE SERVICE OF THE DESCRIPTIVE. It is instructive precisely because it shows WHAT IS LOST when a feature of the actual scheme is dropped.

WHAT THE PROGRAMME COMMITS STRAWSON TO

- (a) conclusions concern OUR CONCEPTUAL SCHEME, not a theory-free proof of mind-independent reality
- (b) the arguments are TRANSCENDENTAL IN FORM
- (c) an empiricist may ACCEPT the whole of Individuals as excellent CONCEPTUAL GEOGRAPHY while DENYING that it settles what exists. THIS IS THE STRONGEST REPLY AVAILABLE TO THE EMPIRICIST, AND CONCEDING IT STRENGTHENS AN ANSWER.

OBJECTION -> REPLY -> COST

CIRCULAR OR CONSERVATIVE: it protects the scheme used to state its own conditions -> the task is avowedly INTERNAL; radical revision and scepticism must BEGIN within some functioning scheme -> DESCRIPTION ALONE CANNOT PROVE THE SCHEME UNIQUELY CORRECT.

SOURCE: Individuals, 1959. The phrase is in the SUBTITLE.

FATAL ERROR: two definitions with NO EXAMPLES.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 37/42: STRAWSON - BASIC PARTICULARS, THE FIVE-STEP ARGUMENT

THE QUESTION - ASK IT PROPERLY FIRST

Of all the PARTICULARS we can identify and refer to - tables, persons, events, sounds, sense-data, numbers - which are ONTOLOGICALLY BASIC IN OUR CONCEPTUAL SCHEME, i.e. which are the items on which THE POSSIBILITY OF IDENTIFICATION AND REFERENCE IN GENERAL depends?

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THE ARGUMENT (Individuals, 1959, PART I)

- 1 To IDENTIFY a particular we must DISTINGUISH it from other particulars and RE-IDENTIFY it across time.
- 2 Re-identification requires a SINGLE, UNIFIED SPATIO-TEMPORAL FRAMEWORK - one space and one time in which all particulars have locations.
- 3 MATERIAL BODIES are ENDURING, PUBLICLY OBSERVABLE occupants of that framework and provide the standard anchors for DEMONSTRATIVE identification and re-identification.
CAUTION: the framework is NOT a psychological image BUILT OUT OF bodies. It is a CONDITION of our scheme.
- 4 Many DEPENDENT particulars - experiences, events, sounds - are identified THROUGH their relations to PERSONS, BODIES, PLACES and TIMES.
- 5 THEREFORE MATERIAL BODIES ARE BASIC: presupposed by the identification of everything else, and not themselves identifiable only by reference to something more basic.

|

SUPPORTING - REFERENCE AND PREDICATION

Basic particulars are basic OBJECTS OF REFERENCE. The subject-predicate structure of ordinary discourse depends on IDENTIFYING something and then PREDICATING something of it. FEATURE-PLACING expressions such as 'It is raining here' need not identify a particular in full subject-predicate form, but they DO NOT REPLACE the framework through which particular-reference becomes possible.

TRAP: 'basic particulars = atoms or ultimate simples'. They are MACROSCOPIC bodies and PERSONS. NOT microphysical.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 38/42: WHY SENSE-DATA FAIL, AND THE PURELY AUDITORY WORLD

THE EMPIRICIST'S CANDIDATE: SENSE-DATA AS THE BASIC PARTICULARS
(Russell's logical constructions; Carnap's Aufbau; phenomenalism)

THREE DEFECTS, EACH INDEPENDENTLY FATAL

- | | | |
|----------|-------------|--|
| DEFECT 1 | PRIVATE | -> cannot ground PUBLIC identification |
| DEFECT 2 | MOMENTARY | -> cannot be RE-IDENTIFIED |
| DEFECT 3 | NON-SPATIAL | -> lack the spatial relations needed to
CONSTITUTE a framework at all |

THEREFORE material bodies are BASIC - NOT as a metaphysical

preference but as A CONDITION OF THE POSSIBILITY OF REFERENCE.

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THE PURELY AUDITORY WORLD - THE REMOVAL TEST

SET-UP a scheme containing ONLY sounds: pitch, timbre, loudness and TEMPORAL SUCCESSION. No space. No bodies.

PROBLEM objective re-identification needs to distinguish 'the SAME particular encountered again' from 'a NEW particular exactly resembling the first'. Qualitative similarity alone cannot do this.

RESULT a world of pitch and succession alone does NOT YET support robust objective re-identification. STRAWSON'S DISCUSSION DOES NOT SIMPLY PROVE AN AUDITORY SCHEME IMPOSSIBLE. Objective reference would require an ANALOGUE OF SPACE - often reconstructed through a continuously available MASTER-SOUND - that can organise sounds into a public-like framework.

SUPPORTS the need for a framework performing the INDIVIDUATING ROLE that space performs in OUR scheme.

DOES NOT PROVE that every conceivable scheme must contain visual and tactile material bodies EXACTLY LIKE OURS.

|

WHAT KIND OF ARGUMENT THIS IS

NOT a proof of the external world (contrast Moore).

NOT a causal or scientific claim about perception.

TRANSCENDENTAL IN FORM, in a Kantian spirit: from our PRACTICE of objective identification to the CONDITIONS of that practice.

CONCLUSION about the STRUCTURE OF OUR CONCEPTUAL SCHEME.

THIS PANEL IS THE EVALUATIVE CORE OF 2020 Q3(b).

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 39/42: STRAWSON - PERSONS AS A PRIMITIVE CONCEPT

THE THREE POSITIONS ON THE TABLE (Individuals, 1959, CH. 3)

CARTESIAN DUALISM	two substances; experiences belong to an IMMATERIAL SOUL
NO-OWNERSHIP / NO-SUBJECT THEORY	experiences are CAUSALLY DEPENDENT on a body but are NOT literally POSSESSED by a person
PERSON AS PRIMITIVE	the concept is LOGICALLY PRIMITIVE - not analysable into body plus mind

|

THE PREDICATE MATRIX - BOTH CLASSES ON ONE SUBJECT

M-PREDICATES (material) also applicable to MERE BODIES
'weighs 70 kg' | 'is in the kitchen' | 'has brown hair'

P-PREDICATES (personal) ascribing STATES OF CONSCIOUSNESS
'is in pain' | 'is thinking of Vienna' | 'believes it will rain'
| 'intends to leave'

A PERSON IS NOT A BODY TO WHICH A MIND IS ATTACHED. It is a single

concept of an entity that is EQUALLY the subject of both.
'THE CONCEPT OF A PERSON IS LOGICALLY PRIOR TO THAT OF AN
INDIVIDUAL CONSCIOUSNESS.'

|

THE ARGUMENT - SELF-AScription REQUIRES OTHER-AScription

- 1 I ascribe experiences to MYSELF: 'I am in pain.'
- 2 A NECESSARY CONDITION is that I can ascribe predicates of the same general kinds to OTHERS.
- 3 Others are identified as EMBODIED SUBJECTS, and psychological predicates are other-ascribed on PUBLICLY AVAILABLE BEHAVIOURAL AND SITUATIONAL CRITERIA. NOT a simple inference from bodily movements to a hidden Cartesian mind.
- 4 But P-predicates must ALSO be self-ascribable WITHOUT OBSERVATION.
- 5 This DUAL CHARACTER belongs to PREDICATES OF PERSONS.
- 6 THEREFORE the concept of a person is LOGICALLY PRIMITIVE. This is CONCEPTUAL PRIORITY, not the postulation of a third Cartesian substance.

|

THE TWO-WAY IMPOSSIBILITY - WHY IT IS AN ARGUMENT, NOT A STIPULATION
From a PURE CONSCIOUSNESS you never reach public criteria.
From a PURE BODY you never reach ascription without observation.
ONLY A SUBJECT THAT IS ALREADY BOTH SATISFIES BOTH CONDITIONS.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 40/42: THE TWO RIVALS DESTROYED, AND THE EXACT VERDICT

CARTESIAN DUALISM - TWO FAILURES

IDENTIFICATION how do we ever IDENTIFY or RE-IDENTIFY an
 immaterial soul? We cannot locate it in space, and
 identification requires ONE framework.

INTERACTION once the substances are separated, their commerce
 becomes unintelligible.

STRAWSON'S MOVE he does NOT ask how mind and body interact; he
 shows that THE QUESTION PRESUPPOSES A PRIOR UNITY THAT NEITHER TERM
 CAN SUPPLY.

|

NO-OWNERSHIP - SELF-REFUTATION IN ONE MOVE

To state the thesis the theorist must specify WHICH experiences.
He says: 'ALL THE EXPERIENCES THAT ARE HAD BY THIS BODY'.

'HAD BY' IS A POSSESSIVE RELATION. Contingent causal dependence
cannot replace it, because dependence does not single out THESE
experiences rather than any others.

HE THEREFORE RECONSTRUCTS THE PERSONAL FRAMEWORK HE SET OUT TO
AVOID. (The view is traced through SCHLICK and
Wittgenstein-influenced writers, and RECONSTRUCTED AND CRITICISED
by Strawson.)

|

THE EXACT VERDICT - WRITE THIS, NOT MORE

DUALISM	treats independently identifiable mind and body as conceptually prior. Strawson's analysis UNDERCUTS THAT STARTING POINT; it does NOT by itself prove every metaphysical dualist thesis false.
NO-OWNERSHIP	eliminates the person while relying on a UNIQUELY RELEVANT BODY and a class of experiences; it RECONSTRUCTS the framework it tried to avoid.
OVERALL	the mind-body problem is DISSOLVED rather than SOLVED: the decomposition that generates it is ILLICIT.
THE COST	'PRIMITIVE' MARKS THE END OF ANALYSIS RATHER THAN AN EXPLANATION of the psychophysical unity - legitimate for descriptive metaphysics, unsatisfying for anybody who wanted the problem SOLVED.

TRAP: refuting ONLY dualism. The chapter turns on the SECOND rival.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 41/42: THE ANSWER-WRITING SPINE, PART ONE

STEP 1 DECIDE THE OWNER FROM THE STEM

two dogmas | analytic | synthetic | reductionism | web of belief |
 affirm any sentence | a priori as article of faith | empiricism
 without the dogmas QUINE
 basic particulars | material bodies | spatio-temporal | person |
 primitive concept | mind-body dualism | descriptive
 metaphysics STRAWSON
 'critique of empiricism' with no further signal QUINE LEADS;
 Strawson enters as ONE bounded paragraph, never as co-author.

STEP 2 DECODE THE DIRECTIVE - AND AVOID ITS FATAL ERROR

EXPLAIN THE THEORY OF BASIC PARTICULARS -> an ARGUMENT FROM IDENTIFICATION. FATAL: listing what a basic particular is.
 DISCUSS THE THEORY OF PERSONS -> the PRIMITIVENESS argument against TWO rivals. FATAL: refuting only dualism.
 EVALUATE THE ROLE OF SPATIO-TEMPORAL THINKING -> REMOVE space and see what fails. FATAL: describing space and time.
 COMMENT ON THE QUOTATION -> the CONDITIONAL CLAUSE is the doctrine; modus tollens, then Neptune/Vulcan. FATAL: quoting the first half and calling it relativism.
 EXAMINE THE ANALYTIC/SYNTHETIC DISTINCTION -> the failed explications as a CHAIN. FATAL: inferring from one missing definition that nothing can be called analytic.
 DISTINGUISH DESCRIPTIVE FROM REVISIONARY -> give STRAWSON'S OWN EXAMPLES. FATAL: two definitions with no examples.
 CRITICALLY / EVALUATE / DO YOU AGREE -> a GRADED VERDICT.

FATAL: a balanced summary with no ruling.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 42/42: THE ANSWER-WRITING SPINE, PART TWO

STEP 3 RUN THE SPINE

QUINE dogma 1 (circle) -> dogma 2 (reductionism) -> holism
(web + both quotations) -> Duhem-Quine (modus tollens,
Neptune/Vulcan) -> limits (minimum mutilation, 1970) ->
verdict (empiricism reformed, not abandoned)

STRAWSON descriptive vs revisionary -> identification needs
re-identification needs ONE framework -> sense-data are
private, momentary, non-spatial -> MATERIAL BODIES BASIC
-> persons: M + P predicates on ONE thing ->
self-ascription requires other-ascription -> dualism AND
no-ownership both presuppose what they deny -> verdict

STEP 4 CLOSE WITH THE QUALIFICATION THAT LIFTS THE ANSWER

QUINE the result is the FAILURE OF AN EXPLICATION, not the
claim that 'all bachelors are unmarried' is false.

STRAWSON the result is about OUR CONCEPTUAL SCHEME; an empiricist
can accept the whole of Individuals as conceptual
geography while denying that it settles what exists.
CONCEDING THIS STRENGTHENS THE ANSWER.

FOUR CHEAP MARKS

cite 'Two Dogmas' to SECTION 6 | date the bound-variable slogan to
1948 | name GRICE alongside Strawson | quote the SUBTITLE of
Individuals

NEVER WRITE

'Quine rejected empiricism' | 'Strawson defended empiricism' |
'Duhem and Quine hold the same thesis' | 'Quine denied meaning
tout court' | 'Putnam/Birkhoff' | 'basic particulars are atoms' |
'person is primitive = dualism'

END OF ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM - 42 PANELS

12. 2026 ownership update and exact demand

2026 Q3(a), 20 marks: "Why are states of consciousness ascribed to anything at all and why are they ascribed to the same things to which we also ascribe physical properties? How does Strawson answer these questions in his work *Individuals*?"

This is directly owned by Strawson's theory of persons. The answer must connect the possibility of P-predication to one identifiable subject of both physical and psychological predicates; explain the asymmetry of self- and other-ascription; and show why an independently identifiable Cartesian ego cannot ground the practice. It is not an invitation to replace *Individuals* with reactive attitudes or a generic mind-body essay.

13. Additional precision controls

Quine

- **Canonical notation:** first regiment the accepted theory; then inspect what its bound variables must range over. The slogan is a commitment criterion after theory choice, not noun-counting and not an ontology-selection algorithm.
- **Indispensability:** Quine's parsimony does not entail nominalism at any cost. Abstract commitment can follow indispensable quantification in best science; the broader Quine-Putnam argument is not identical with the slogan.
- **Proxy functions:** systematic object permutations can preserve sentence-level truth, strengthening the claim that reference is fixed only relative to a background interpretation.
- **Underdetermination:** evidential equivalence between scientific theories does not by itself yield translation indeterminacy. The latter adds Quine's contested naturalistic thesis that no further semantic fact selects a manual.
- **Logical laws:** the early essay includes logic in revisability in principle. Later Quine's minimum-mutilation conservatism and "change of logic, change of subject" warning qualify any casual appeal to quantum logic.

Strawson

- **Subject-predicate framework:** ordinary predication normally presupposes successful identification of a subject. Feature-placing expressions complicate but do not abolish the framework.
- **Other minds:** public criteria for other-ascription are not reductive behaviourism. The same P-predicate is other-ascribed on behavioural/situational criteria and self-ascribed without observation.
- **Uniqueness and context:** "On Referring" distinguishes sentence meaning from a speaker's use on an occasion. Context can fix whom a speaker intends without making every uniqueness condition the conversational assertion.
- **Presupposition caution:** the meaningful sentence-type does not become meaningless. Strawson's original treatment concerns an unsuccessful use that ordinarily fails to make a true-or-false assertion; later theories vary.
- **Reactive attitudes:** *Freedom and Resentment* is source-recognized bounded enrichment, not printed core or independent PYQ ownership here.

14. Exact owned PYQs through 2026

Year	Part	Marks	Primary demand
2018	Q1(e)	10	Strawson's concept of person
2018	Q2(c)	15	Quine on the Kantian a priori

Year	Part	Marks	Primary demand
2019	Q1(e)	10	argument against analytic/synthetic distinction
2020	Q3(b)	15	spatio-temporal thinking and objective thought
2021	Q3(b)	15	material bodies and persons as basic particulars
2021	Q3(c)	15	empiricism without the dogmas
2023	Q4(a)	20	person as primitive and mind-body dualism
2024	Q4(c)	15	nature of the two dogmas
2025	Q4(b)	15	web of belief and revisability quotation
2026	Q3(a)	20	states of consciousness and physical properties in <i>Individuals</i>

No Topic 11 question was primary-owned in 2022. Russell's 2023 Q4(b) and related description questions remain Topic 06-owned; Logical Positivism questions remain Topic 07-owned even where Quine supplies criticism.

15. Closed-book register

1. State the **two-project firewall** before comparison.
2. Reproduce the analyticity circle: meaning -> synonymy -> definition/interchangeability/necessity/semantical rules -> circularity or residual unclarity.
3. Derive holism from the rejection of sentence-by-sentence reduction.
4. Qualify universal revisability through pragmatic conservatism and later logical caution.
5. Separate commitment, indispensability, translation indeterminacy, reference inscrutability and ontological relativity.
6. Derive bodies from identification plus re-identification in one public space-time.
7. Derive persons from one subject of M- and P-predicates plus self-/other-ascription.
8. State the Russell-Strawson split as asserted existence/uniqueness versus presupposition in use, without calling the sentence meaningless.
9. End comparative answers with a layered verdict, not a fabricated Quine-Strawson school.

16. Recall prompts

- Can you explain why definition cannot create cognitive synonymy by stipulation alone?
- Can you derive not-(H and A) without pretending that evidence names the guilty conjunct?
- Can you distinguish stimulus meaning, observation sentence, analytical hypothesis, inscrutability and indeterminacy?
- Can you explain why "primitive person" is neither dualism, materialism nor a third substance?

- Can you state what descriptive metaphysics proves internally and what it leaves externally open?
- Can you answer the 2026 question without drifting into reactive attitudes?